

Airline Website Stage 1 Report

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Section 1: User Requirements

Target Users

The airline booking interface is intended to support a diverse range of users, including:

- University students booking affordable or last-minute flights
- Families planning vacations
- Business travelers prioritizing efficiency and flexibility
- Elderly users with limited technical experience
- International travelers managing passports, visas, and baggage requirements

Functional Requirements

The system should allow users to:

- Search for flights using origin, destination, dates, and number of passengers
- Compare flight options based on price, duration, and stops
- Select seats, baggage options, and additional services
- Create or access an account to manage bookings
- Complete secure online payments
- View, modify, or cancel existing bookings
- Access customer support and travel information

Non-Functional Requirements

The interface should:

- Be intuitive and easy to learn
- Minimize the number of steps required to complete a booking
- Provide clear feedback after each user action
- Be accessible to users with disabilities
- Protect user privacy and financial data

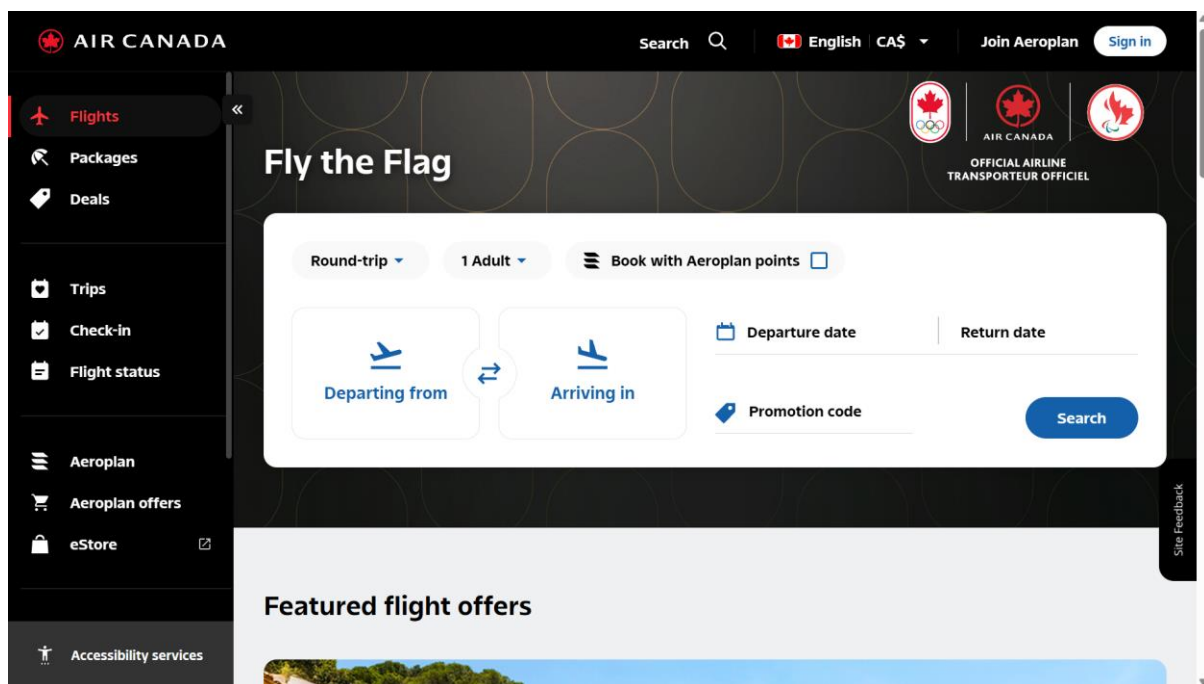
Section 2: Website Analysis

We analyzed the following 3 airline websites:

1. [Air Canada](#)
2. [Saudia](#)
3. [Emirates](#)

2.1 Air Canada

1. **Home Page:** The homepage prominently displays the flight search tool, allowing users to select trip type, destinations, dates, and number of passengers. Additional quick links include vacation packages, Aeroplan login, and travel updates.



2. **Search Page:** The flight search page allows users to enter departure and arrival airports, select dates, and apply promotion codes. The interface is visually appealing, with a large background image and clear input fields. Users can also toggle “Book with Aeroplan points.”

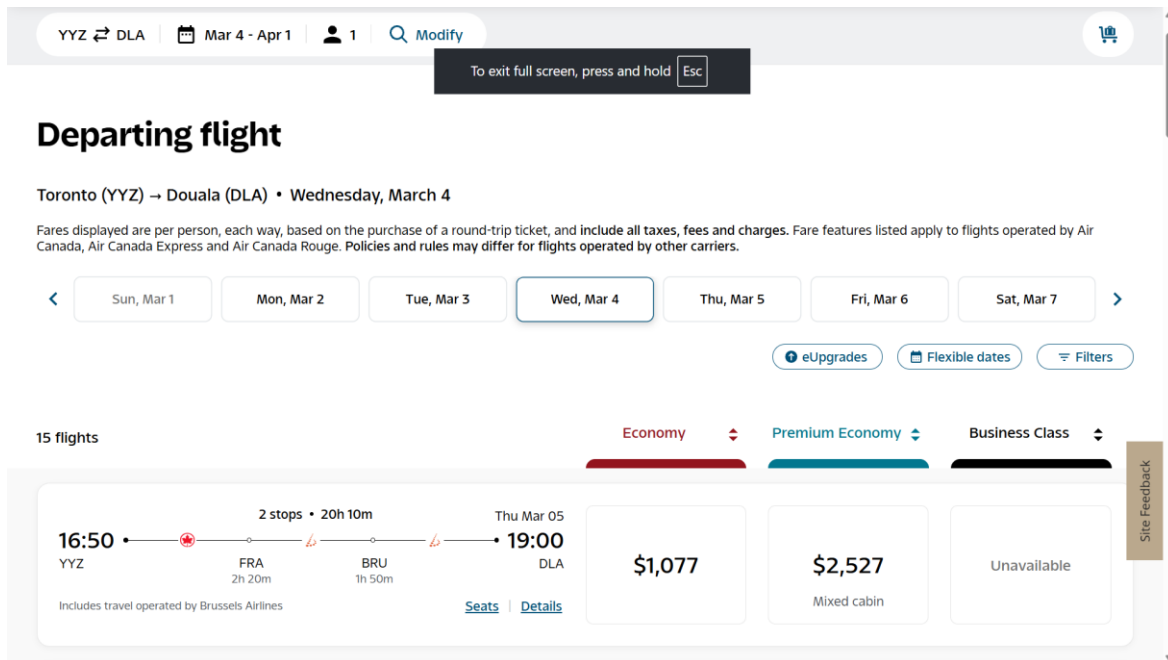


Figure 1. Air Canada Search Page

3. Result Page: After entering search details, users are shown a list of available flights. It provides:

- Filters for price, number of stops, travel duration, and flexible dates
- Indicators for partner-operated flights
- Clear fare categories (Economy, Premium Economy, Business Class)
- Date navigation to compare prices across nearby days

Each flight card includes departure/arrival times, layovers, total travel time, and fare options.

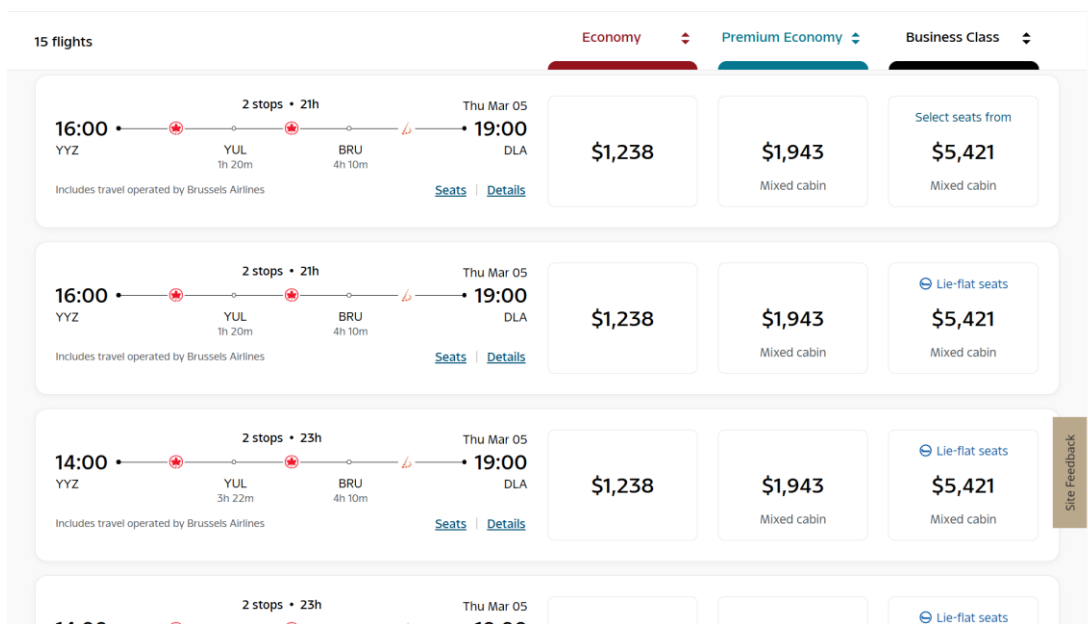


Figure 2. Air Canada Search Results

4. **Fare Comparison Page:** Air Canada displays multiple fare classes with detailed breakdowns:

- Economy Standard
- Economy Flex
- Economy Comfort
- Economy Latitude
- Premium Economy (Lowest & Flexible)
- Business Class (Lowest & Flexible)

Each fare includes information on baggage allowance, refundability, seat selection, and Aeroplan point earning.

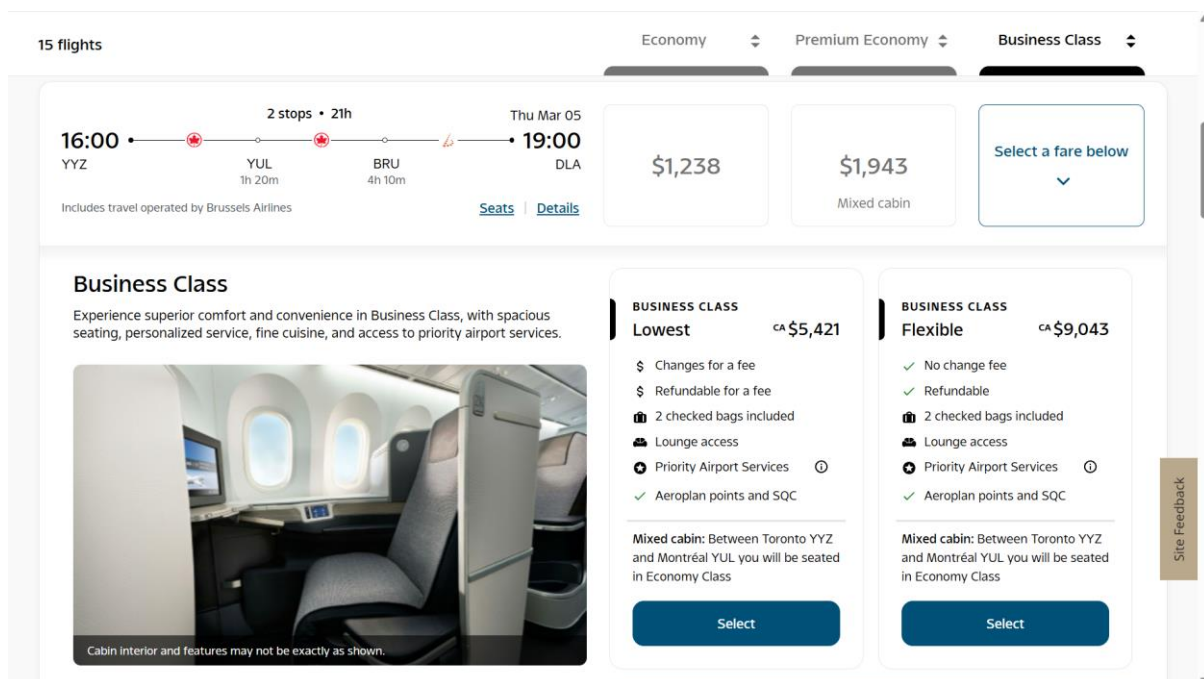


Figure 3. Fare Comparison Interface

5. **Return Flight Options:** The return flight page mirrors the outbound results, showing:

- Multiple flight combinations
- Layover durations
- Partner airline segments
- Price differences across fare classes
- Indicators for lie-flat seats in Business Class

6. **Seat Selection Interface**

Seat Selection (Business):

The Business Class seat preview highlights:

- Lie-flat seats
- Priority boarding
- Lounge access
- Gourmet meals and wine
- Aircraft layout with unavailable and available seats

This gives users a clear understanding of the premium experience.

Seat Selection (Premium Economy):

Premium Economy offers:

- More recline and comfort
- Priority services
- Complimentary meals and beverages
- Mixed-cabin notes when applicable

The seat map shows available seats, lavatories, and emergency exits.

Seat Selection (Economy)

Economy seat maps include:

- Preferred seats with extra space
- Standard seats
- Bassinet locations
- Lavatories and galley markers

Users can preview seat availability before selecting.

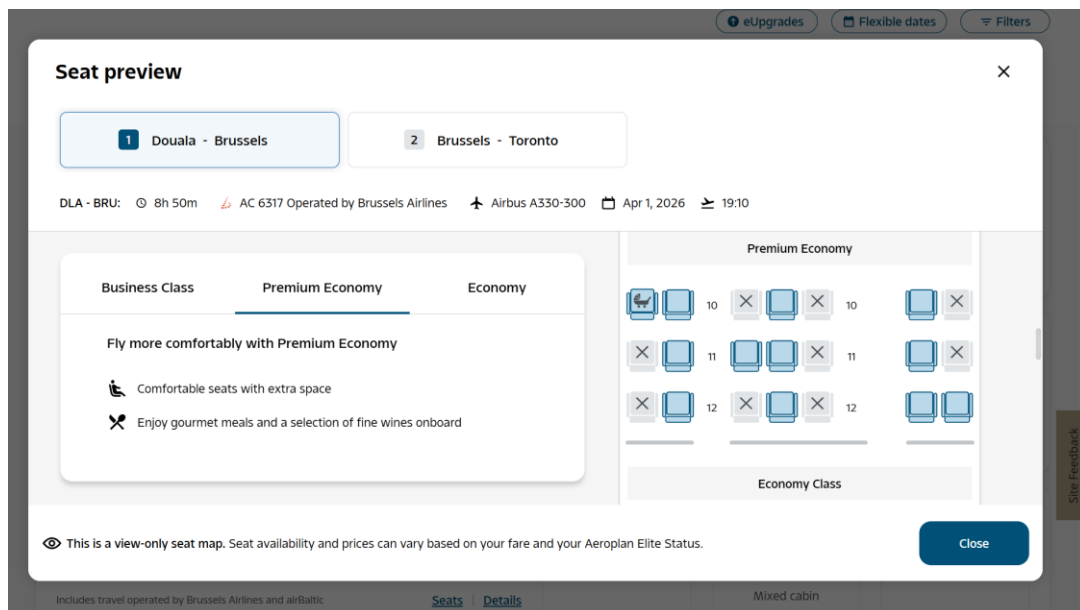


Figure 4. Seat Selection Preview

7. Booking Review Page

The trip review page summarizes:

- Outbound and return flight details
- Fare rules
- Total price breakdown
- Cancellation policies
- Timer indicating how long the fare is held

This page ensures transparency before payment.

8. Session Timeout Page

Air Canada automatically ends inactive sessions to protect user data. The timeout page offers options to resume the last search or return to the homepage.

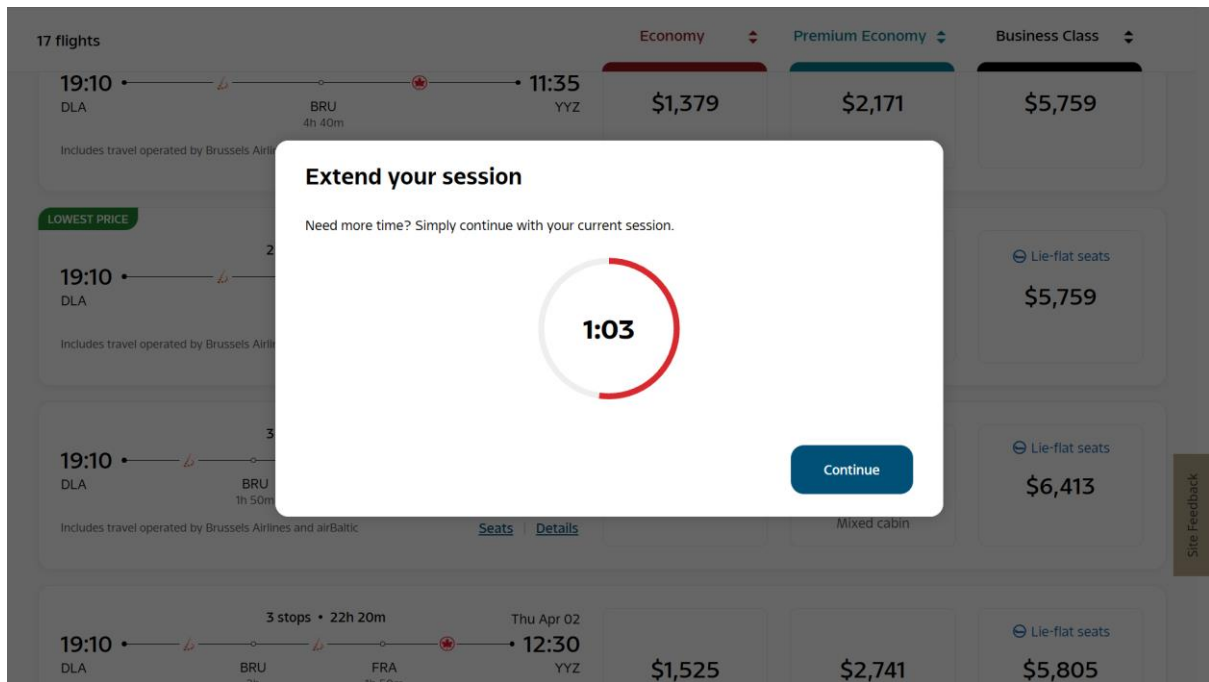


Figure 5. Session Timeout Interface

9. Check In Page

The check-in page allows users to enter:

- Booking reference
- Aeroplan number
- Passenger last name

It also provides travel tips, baggage information, and advisories.

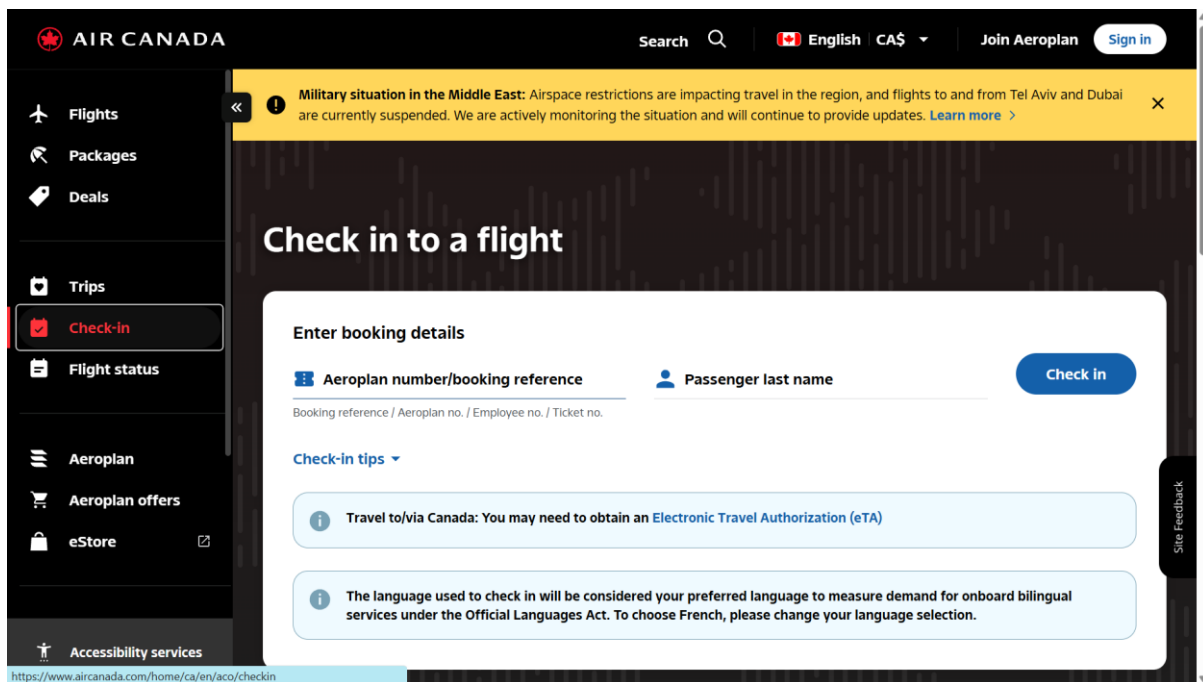


Figure 6. Check In Page

10. Trips (Manage Booking)

Users can retrieve existing reservations by entering their booking reference or ticket number. Additional links include travel advisories and baggage information.

11. Aeroplan Program

The Aeroplan page highlights:

- Earning points on flights, hotels, dining, and shopping
- Redeeming points for flights, upgrades, hotels, car rentals, and gift cards
- Free onboard texting and Wi-Fi for members
- Partner rewards and eStore options

12. Hotels Booking Page

Air Canada allows users to book hotels directly through Aeroplan, with features such as:

- Booking with points
- HotelSavers discounts
- Guest selection
- Destination and date inputs

13. Promotions and Deals Page

The Deals page showcases:

- Seasonal promotions

- Bonus Aeroplan point offers
- Destination-specific discounts
- Global travel statistics (destinations, daily flights, continents served)

Fares on sale that take you everywhere
Just enter your departure city, and we'll show you the sale fares to get there. With over 180 destinations worldwide, you've got options.

Canada U.S. Caribbean Latin America Europe Asia Pacific

Input origin Input destination CAD Input max budget Popular

Toronto (YYZ) to Vancouver (YVR) Apr 19, 2026 From CAD 181* Viewed: 12 minutes ago One-way / Economy Book Now	Vancouver (YVR) to Toronto (YYZ) Mar 30, 2026 From CAD 152* Viewed: 5 minutes ago One-way / Economy Book Now	Toronto (YYZ) to Calgary (YYC) Mar 25, 2026 From CAD 169* Viewed: 15 minutes ago One-way / Economy Book Now	Montréal (YUL) to Vancouver (YVR) Apr 10, 2026 From CAD 223* Viewed: 12 minutes ago One-way / Economy Book Now
Vancouver (YVR) to Montréal (YUL) Apr 11, 2026 From CAD 167* Viewed: 41 minutes ago One-way / Economy Book Now	Calgary (YYC) to Toronto (YYZ) Mar 28, 2026 From CAD 157* Viewed: 46 minutes ago One-way / Economy Book Now	Montréal (YUL) to Calgary (YYC) May 03, 2026 From CAD 184* Viewed: 11 minutes ago One-way / Economy Book Now	Toronto (YYZ) to Montréal (YUL) Apr 13, 2026 From CAD 199* Viewed: 2 hours ago One-way / Economy Book Now
Toronto (YYZ) to Edmonton (YEG) Apr 08, 2026 From CAD 164* Viewed: 31 minutes ago Book Now	Calgary (YYC) to Vancouver (YVR) May 09, 2026 From CAD 110* Viewed: 4 minutes ago Book Now	Toronto (YYZ) to Halifax (YHZ) Mar 28, 2026 From CAD 124* Viewed: 31 minutes ago Book Now	Edmonton (YEG) to Toronto (YYZ) Apr 21, 2026 From CAD 147* Viewed: 32 minutes ago Book Now

Figure 7. Deals Page

14. Accessibility Services

Air Canada provides a dedicated accessibility section outlining its commitment to inclusive travel. The page emphasizes support for passengers with visible and non-visible disabilities and highlights the airline's goal of creating barrier-free travel experiences.

Accessibility Services Categories

Air Canada organizes its accessibility offerings into clear categories, each represented by an informational card. These include:

- Airport wheelchair assistance
- Curbside assistance
- Hearing support
- Medical devices and oxygen
- Personal mobility aids
- Non-visible disabilities

- Service/emotional support dogs
- Severe allergies
- Special seating
- Support person policies
- Vision assistance

Each card links to detailed guidelines, eligibility requirements, and instructions for requesting support.

Additional Accessibility Information

This section provides further resources, including:

- Alternate formats for documents
- Additional accessibility services
- Medical approval requirements
- Rights and regulations for passengers

Air Canada also clarifies which services apply only to flights operated by Air Canada, Air Canada Rouge, and Air Canada Express.

[Our accessibility services](#)
[Questions and concerns](#)
[Accessibility plan and feedback process](#)



Our accessibility services

Through our wide range of accessibility services, we're committed to offering a seamless travel experience for all our customers.

If you have a visible or non-visible disability, our agents can help you board in advance to give you extra time to locate your seat, store your carry-on, and get comfortable before the aisles get busy.

For this, please arrive at least 30 mins ahead of [recommended boarding time](#).



Airport wheelchair assistance

Find out how to request wheelchair assistance at the airport, and services including transfer to your aircraft seat.

[About airport wheelchair assistance >](#)



Curbside assistance

If you require curbside assistance at the airport, you'll need to make arrangements with the airport you are flying into or out of.

[About curbside assistance >](#)



Hearing

For those who are Deaf or hard of hearing, we have options to help you travel with ease.

[About hearing services >](#)



Medical devices and oxygen

Learn about our policies for travelling with your portable medical device.

[About medical devices and oxygen >](#)



Personal mobility aids

Find everything you need to know about travelling with your personal mobility aid.

[About personal mobility aids >](#)



Non-visible disabilities

If you have a non-visible disability, you can request assistance directly or through the Hidden Disabilities Sunflower program.

[About non-visible disabilities >](#)

Figure 8. Check In Page

Overview:

Air Canada’s website provides a comprehensive and user-friendly booking experience. The platform integrates flight search, fare comparison, seat selection, and booking management seamlessly. Additional services such as Aeroplan rewards, hotel bookings, car rentals, and travel advisories enhance the overall user experience.

The navigation menu is consistent across all pages, making it easy for users to switch between booking, checking in, managing trips, and exploring loyalty benefits.

Key Features

Flight Booking

- Intuitive search interface
- Detailed flight results with filters
- Transparent fare breakdowns
- Multi-cabin seat previews

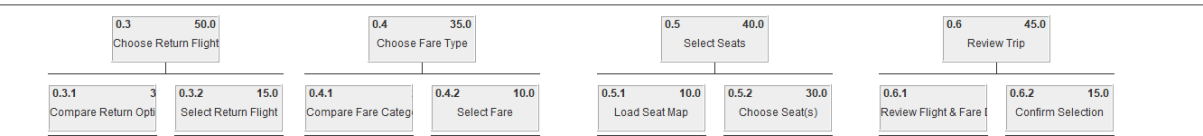
Customer Support

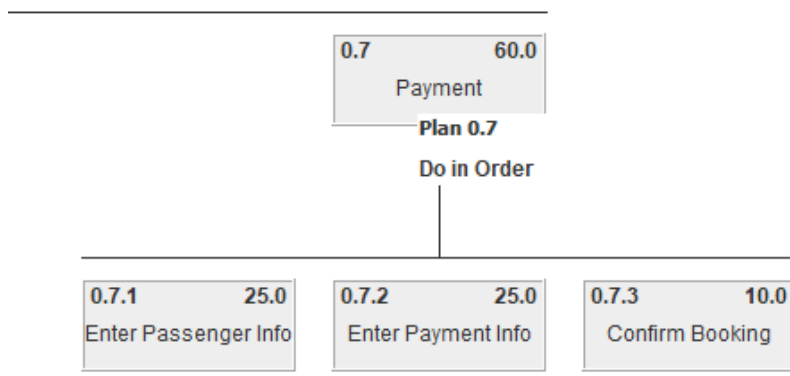
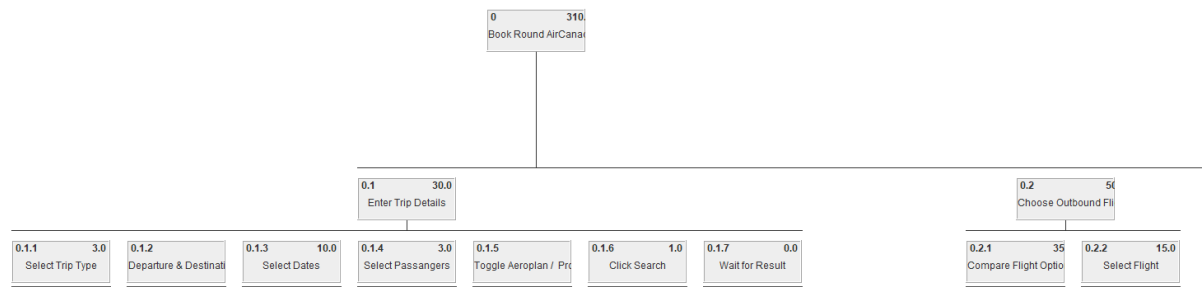
- Travel advisories
- Baggage information
- Session timeout security
- Manage booking tools

Additional Services

- Aeroplan loyalty program
- Hotels and car rentals
- Packages and deals
- Flight status and check-in

HTA Analysis for Air Canada





2.2 Saudia Airlines

1. Homepage

The Saudia homepage presents a modern, visually rich interface with a strong emphasis on clarity and brand identity. A prominent flight booking widget is placed at the center of the page, allowing users to immediately begin the booking process. Users can select trip type, origin and destination, travel dates, passenger count, and cabin class without navigating away from the homepage.

The interface demonstrates a clear visual hierarchy that effectively draws attention to the primary booking task, while high-quality imagery enhances a sense of professionalism and trust. Promotional content, loyalty benefits, and travel advisories are visible but remain non-intrusive, allowing users to stay focused on their goals. However, the visually rich backgrounds may slightly distract users who prefer a faster, task-oriented experience, and first-time users may require a moment to process the amount of information presented on the page.

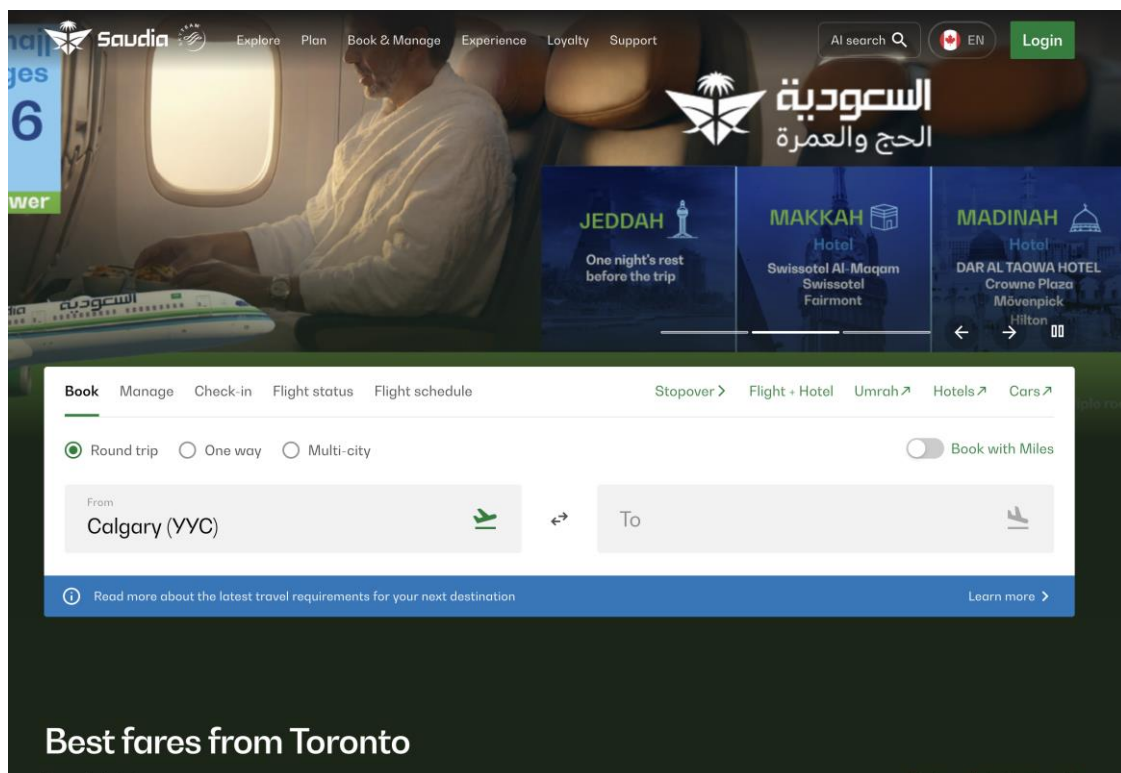


Figure 9. Saudia Homepage

2. Flight Booking Process

The flight booking interface supports one-way, round-trip, and multi-city searches. Users can select cabin class (Guest, Business, First), apply promotional codes, and toggle the option to redeem loyalty miles. Inputs are logically grouped, reducing the likelihood of user error.

The interface features a clean layout with clearly labeled form controls, making the booking process easy to understand and navigate. It supports both cash and miles bookings, accommodating different user goals and increasing flexibility. The simple interaction flow helps minimize cognitive load and allows users to complete tasks efficiently. However, advanced options such as promo codes or miles redemption may be overlooked by inexperienced users if they are not clearly emphasized within the layout.

The screenshot shows a flight search interface with the following elements:

- Navigation Bar:** Book, Manage, Check-in, Flight status, Flight schedule, Stopover, Flight + Hotel, Umrah, Hotels, Cars.
- Search Type:** Round trip (selected), One way, Multi-city. A toggle for "Book with Miles" is on the right.
- Origin and Destination:** From: Calgary (YYC), To: Abha (AHB).
- Recent searches:**
 - Calgary → Abha - 02 Mar - 04 Mar
 - Calgary → Abu Dhabi - 12 Apr - 15 Apr
- Footer:** Read more about the latest travel requirements for your next destination. Learn more.

Figure 10. Flight Searching Interface

The screenshot shows a flight results page with the following elements:

- Header:** Book flights to Al Qurayyāt (URY) starting at SAR 659.
- Filters:** Round trip, 1 Passenger, Economy.
- Search Form:** From: Select origin, To: Al Qurayyāt (URY), Saudi A..., Departure: DDD, DD MMM, Return: DDD, DD MMM, Search button.
- Breadcrumbs:** Home > Flights > To Saudi Arabia > Flights to Al Qurayyāt.
- Section:** Our Most Searched Flights on Saudia for the next 30 days.
- Flight Results Grid:**

From	To	Dates	Price	Action
Riyadh (RUH) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)	Riyadh (RUH) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)	Sun, 01 Mar - Sun, 01 Mar	SAR 665*	Book Now
Riyadh (RUH) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)	Riyadh (RUH) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)	Sun, 08 Mar - Sat, 21 Mar	SAR 659*	Book Now
Jeddah (JED) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)	Jeddah (JED) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)	Sat, 21 Mar - Sun, 22 Mar	SAR 1,080*	Book Now
Jeddah (JED) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)	Jeddah (JED) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)	Sun, 01 Mar - Mon, 02 Mar	SAR 1,199*	Book Now
Dammam (DMM) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)	Dammam (DMM) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)	Sun, 01 Mar - Thu, 05 Mar	SAR 1,671*	Book Now
Dammam (DMM) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)	Dammam (DMM) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)	Wed, 18 Mar - Tue, 31 Mar	SAR 1,185*	Book Now
Abha (AHB) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)	Abha (AHB) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)	Sat, 21 Mar - Mon, 23 Mar	SAR 1,160*	Book Now

Figure 11. Different Search Results

3. Flight Results Page

The results page presents flight options in a structured card-based layout. Each option displays departure and arrival times, aircraft type, total travel duration, layover information, and fare categories. Filtering tools allow users to refine results by price, number of stops, and schedule.

The interface provides a detailed yet readable presentation of flight information, allowing users to compare options effectively without excessive confusion. Filtering tools improve efficiency, particularly for experienced users who want to refine results quickly. The use of “Details” buttons helps reduce visual clutter by keeping additional information accessible but not immediately displayed. However, new users may still feel slightly overwhelmed by the overall amount of data presented on the results page.

The screenshot shows the Saudia flight booking interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with the Saudia logo, a progress indicator (1 Flight), and buttons for Passengers, Seats & Extras, and Payment. On the right are 'Edit search' and 'Login' buttons. Below this is a search bar with 'Departing - Mar 02' and 'Returning - Mar 04'. The origin is YYC and the destination is AHB. There are toggle switches for 'Book with miles' and 'See flexible dates +/- 3 days'.

The main heading is '1. Calgary → Abha'. Below it is a date selector showing 'Mon, 02 Mar' as the selected date. The date selector also includes options for 'Tue, 03 Mar', 'Wed, 04 Mar', 'Thu, 05 Mar', 'Fri, 06 Mar', 'Sat, 07 Mar', and 'Sun, 08 Mar'. The 'Mon, 02 Mar' option shows 'No flights', while 'Tue, 03 Mar' shows 'Upgrade To Business'.

Below the date selector, it says '5 of 5 Results'. There are filters for 'Filter by: Non-stop · No Flights', '1 stop · No Flights', and '2+ stops' (which is selected). There is also a 'Sort by: Default' option.

The flight results are displayed in a table-like format. Each row represents a flight option. The first four rows show flights from YYC to AHB. The first row is the 'Lowest fare' option, with a departure time of 09:40 and an arrival time of 19:05. It shows '2 stops · 23h 25m' and a duration of '+1 day'. The fare is 'Sold out' for the 'Guest' class and '5,360.62' for the 'Business' class. The other three rows show similar flight options with different departure times (09:00, 07:10, and 06:30) and similar arrival times (19:05). The 'Guest' class is 'Sold out' for all, while the 'Business' class has fares of 5,360.62, 5,360.62, and 7,307.62 respectively.

Lowest fare	Guest	Business
YYC 09:40 → AHB 19:05 2 stops · 23h 25m +1 day Flight details >	Sold out	From CAD 5,360.62
YYC 09:00 → AHB 19:05 2 stops · 24h 5m +1 day Flight details >	Sold out	Sold out
YYC 07:10 → AHB 19:05 2 stops · 25h 55m +1 day Flight details >	Sold out	From CAD 5,360.62
YYC 06:30 → AHB 19:05 2 stops · 26h 35m +1 day Flight details >	Sold out	From CAD 7,307.62

Figure 12. Results Page (Flight Options)

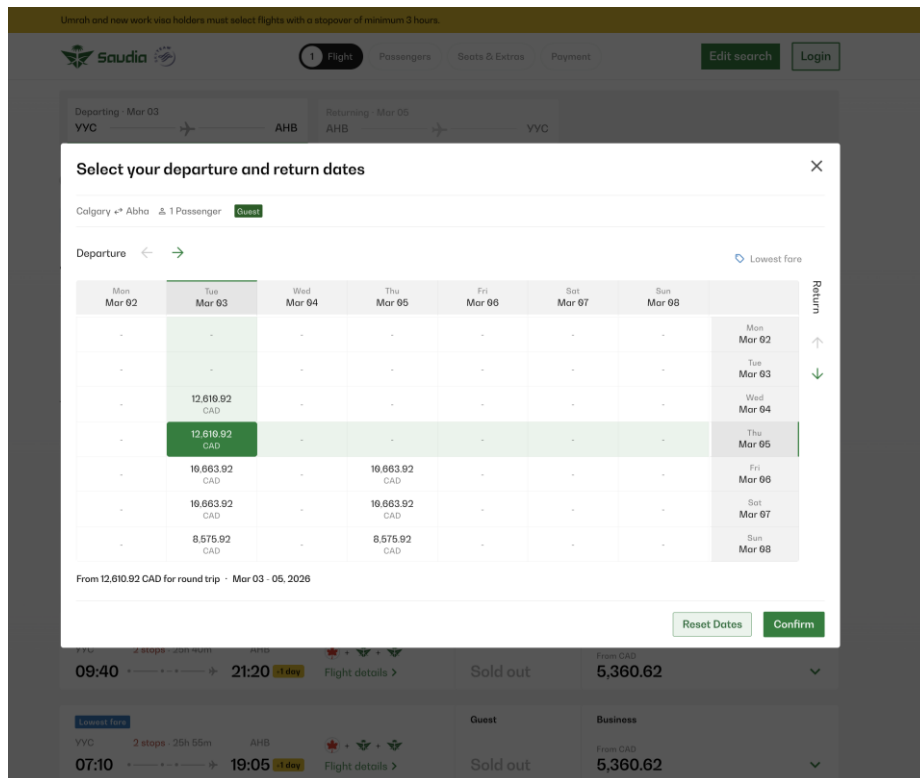


Figure 12. Flexible Date selection interface

4. Fare Options

Saudia offers multiple fare categories, including Guest Saver, Guest Flex, Business Basic, Business Flex, and First Class. Each fare clearly communicates baggage allowance, refundability, seat selection rules, and lounge access for premium cabins.

The interface supports transparent comparison between fare options, enabling users to make informed decisions with greater confidence. Fare benefits are clearly differentiated, helping users understand what is included at each level and reducing uncertainty around hidden fees. This clarity improves trust and minimizes confusion during selection. However, some users may still require additional guidance or contextual recommendations to determine which fare option best suits their needs.



1

Flight

Passengers

Seats & Extras

Payment

Edit search

Login

1. Calgary → Abha

Mon, 02 Mar

No flights

Tue, 03 Mar

Upgrade To Business

Wed, 04 Mar

No flights

Thu, 05 Mar

Try another date

Fri, 06 Mar

Try another date

Sat, 07 Mar

Try another date

Sun, 08 Mar

Try another date

5 of 5 Results

Filter by:

Non-stop • No Flights

1 stop • No Flights

2+ stops ✓

Sort by:
Default

Lowest fare

YVC
2 stops • 23h 25m

AHB

09:40

19:05
1 day

Flight details

Guest

Business

From CAD

5,360.62

Seat selection, AlFursan Miles, and upgrading with Miles are only available on flights with Saudia airlines.

Prices for 1 passenger	Business Basic	Business Flex
	CAD 5,360.62	CAD 5,811.62
Baggage	2pc x 32kg	2pc x 32kg
Advance seat reservation	Free	Free
AlFursan Miles	Upto 125% miles	Upto 175% miles
Upgrade with Miles	✓	✓
Cancellation ⓘ	CAD 460	✓
Flight change ⓘ	CAD 335	✓
Change after departure ⓘ	CAD 655	CAD 460
Cancellation after departure ⓘ	✗	CAD 655
	Select	Select

YVC
2 stops • 24h 5m

AHB

09:00

19:05
1 day

Flight details

Guest

Business

Sold out

Book flights to Al Qurayyāt (URY) starting at SAR 659

Round trip ▾

1 Passenger, Economy ▾

From
 Select origin

To
 Al Qurayyāt (URY), Saudi A... ✕

Departure
 DDD, DD MMM

Return
 DDD, DD MMM

Search

Home > Flights > To Saudi Arabia > Flights to Al Qurayyāt

Our Most Searched Flights on Saudia for the next 30 days

From	To	Dates
✈ Input origin	✈ Al Qurayyāt (URY), Saudi Arabia, G... ✕	Select dates

Riyadh (RUH) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)
 Sun, 01 Mar - Sun, 01 Mar
 From
SAR 665*
 Viewed 1 day ago
 Round-trip / Guest

Book Now

Riyadh (RUH) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)
 Sun, 08 Mar - Sat, 21 Mar
 From
SAR 659*
 Viewed 1 day ago
 Round-trip / Guest

Book Now

Jeddah (JED) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)
 Sat, 21 Mar - Sun, 22 Mar
 From
SAR 1,080*
 Viewed 1 day ago
 Round-trip / Guest

Book Now

Jeddah (JED) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)
 Sun, 01 Mar - Mon, 02 Mar
 From
SAR 1,199*
 Viewed 6 hrs ago
 Round-trip / Guest

Book Now

Dammam (DMM) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)
 Sun, 01 Mar - Thu, 05 Mar
 From
SAR 1,671*
 Viewed 3 hrs ago
 Round-trip / Guest

Book Now

Dammam (DMM) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)
 Wed, 18 Mar - Tue, 31 Mar
 From
SAR 1,185*
 Viewed 1 day ago
 Round-trip / Guest

Book Now

Abha (AHB) to Al Qurayyāt (URY)
 Sat, 21 Mar - Mon, 23 Mar
 From
SAR 1,160*
 Viewed 14 hrs ago
 Round-trip / Guest

Book Now

5. Customer Support

Saudia provides extensive customer support options, including 24/7 regional call centers, live chat, email support, refund and claim forms, and lost baggage services. The support section is multilingual and well organized.

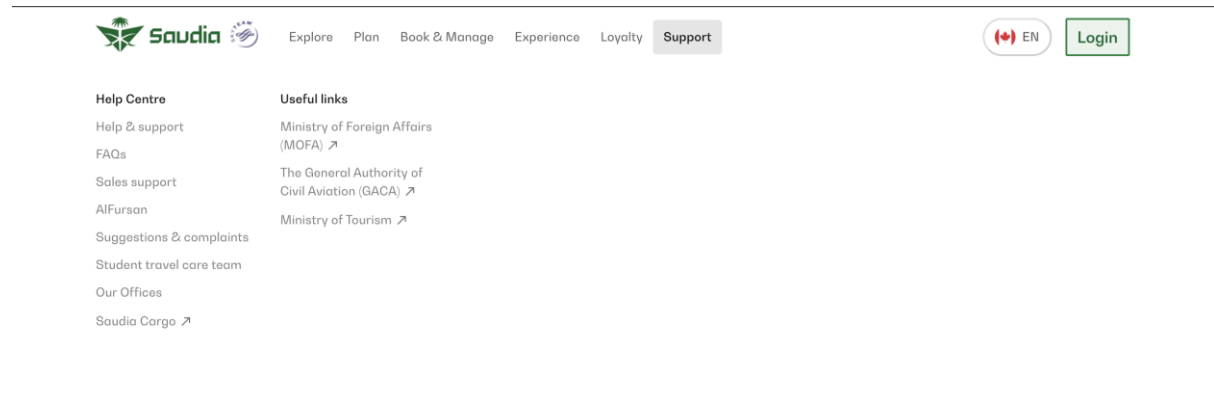


Figure 15. Support Options

6. Additional Services

Loyalty Program (ALFURSAN): The ALFURSAN loyalty program allows users to earn and redeem miles across flights and partner services. Tiered membership (Blue, Silver, Gold) offers increasing benefits, including family pooling options.

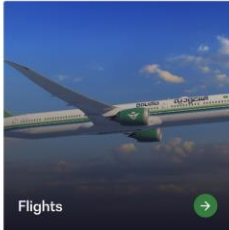
Join a loyalty that never ends

Become an AlFursan member to enjoy exclusive benefits, extra Miles, and more holidays.

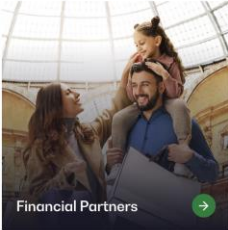
[Join AlFursan →](#)

- More holidays**
Let your Miles take you further with up to 50% off Reward flights
- More possibilities**
Keep your account active and enjoy your Miles without expiry
- More reasons to join**
Up to 150,000 Bonus Miles on AlFursan Miles earning credit cards

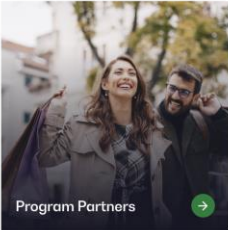
Fly higher with Reward Miles



Flights



Financial Partners



Program Partners

Privileges when you fly

Green	Silver Elite	Gold Elite Plus
Reaching Tier	25K Tier credits or 20 trips	50K Tier credits or 40 trips
Tier Bonus	25% of Miles earned	50% of Miles earned
Priority Boarding	Included	Included
Priority Waitlist	Higher	Highest

[See all benefits →](#)

Figure 16. Loyalty Program Information

7. **Travel Extras:** Additional services include onboard Wi-Fi, special meals, extra baggage, Meet & Assist services, and Umrah and Hajj travel packages.
8. **Accessibility Services:** Saudia provides accessibility services such as wheelchair assistance, special seating, medical equipment policies, and service animal guidelines. The accessibility content is clearly separated and easy to locate.
9. **AI Virtual Assistant:** Saudia integrates an AI-powered virtual assistant to support users with tasks such as flight search, booking assistance, check-in guidance, baggage policies, and general travel inquiries. The agent provides real-time responses and reduces the need for direct human customer support.

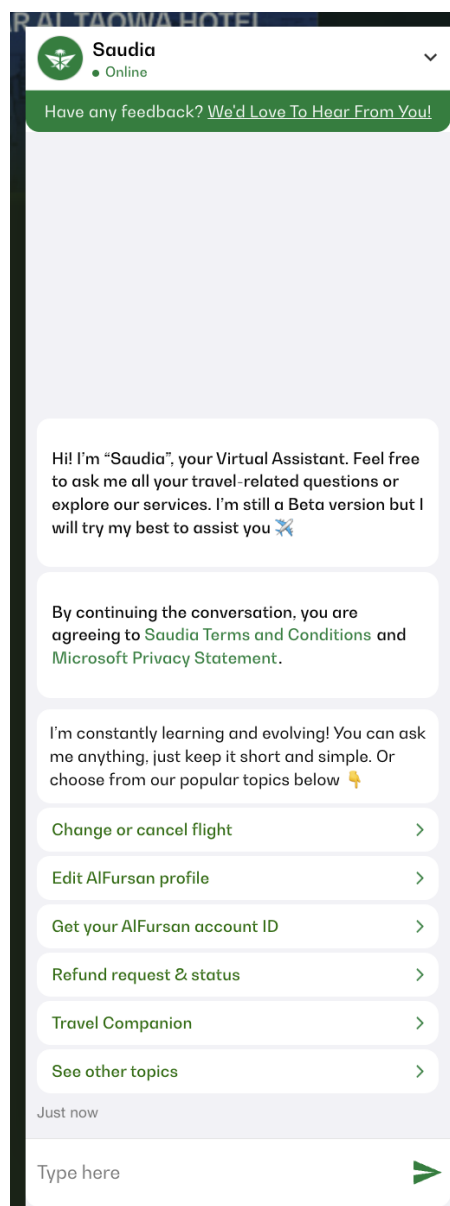


Figure 17. AI Virtual Assistant

Overview

Saudia Airlines' website offers a modern, visually appealing interface designed to support international travelers with diverse needs. The platform integrates flight search, fare comparison, seat selection, and booking management in a streamlined manner. Additional services such as ALFURSAN loyalty rewards, hotel and car booking partnerships, and travel extras (Wi-Fi, special meals, Umrah packages) enhance the overall user experience.

The navigation menu remains consistent across all pages, allowing users to easily switch between booking flights, managing reservations, checking in, and exploring loyalty benefits.

Key Features

Flight Booking

- **Intuitive search interface** with options for round-trip, one-way, and multi-city itineraries
- **Clear flight results** with filters for stops, price, schedule, and aircraft type
- **Transparent fare categories** (Guest Saver, Guest Flex, Business, First)
- **Detailed fare breakdowns** including baggage, refundability, and seat rules
- **Seat previews** for Guest, Business, and First-Class cabins

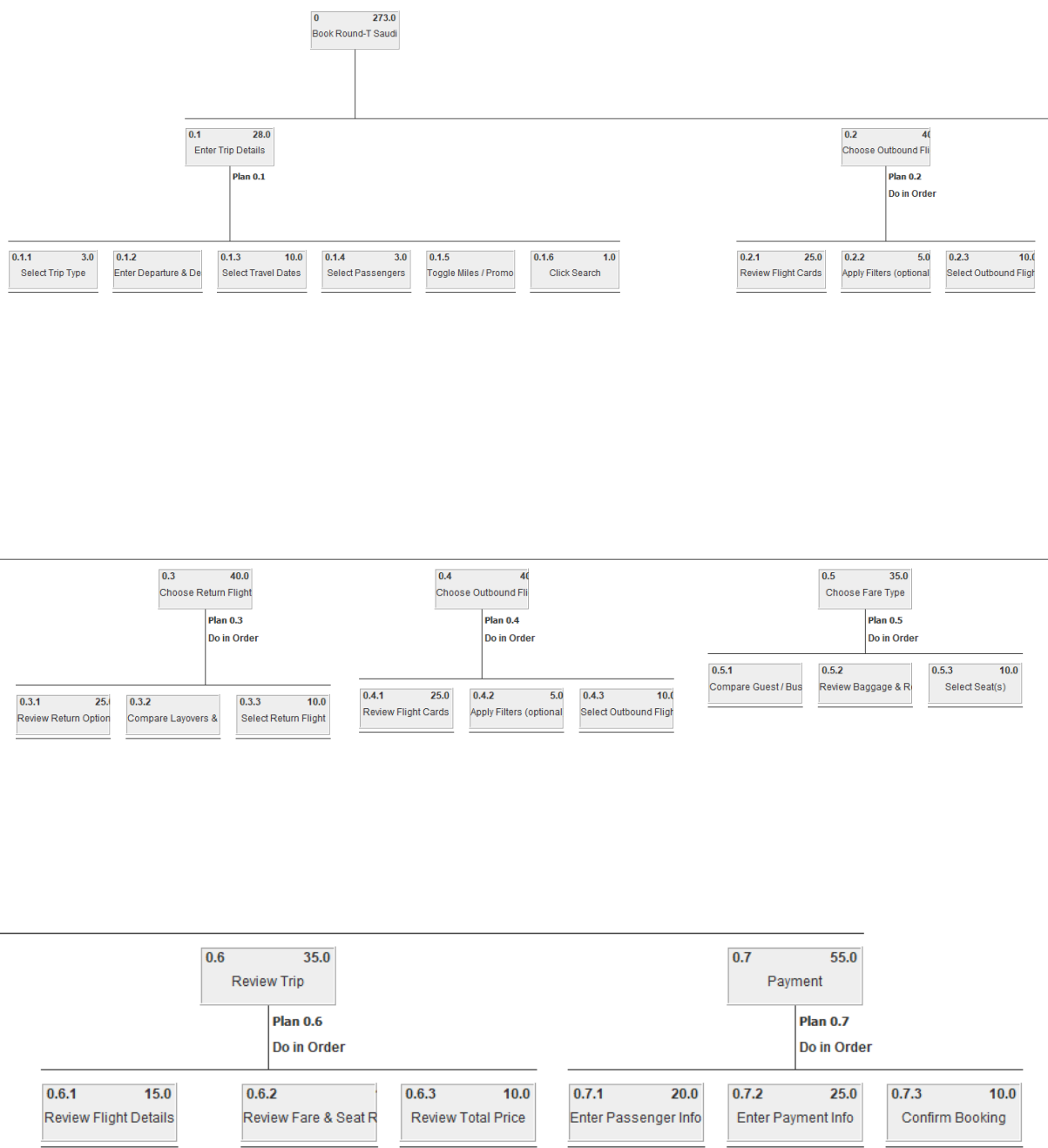
Customer Support

- **24/7 multilingual support** via phone, email, and live chat
- **Lost baggage services** and claim forms
- **Travel advisories** for regional and international routes
- **Refund and modification tools** for managing bookings
- **Accessible travel information** for passengers with disabilities

Additional Services

- **ALFURSAN loyalty program** with miles earning and redemption
- **Hotel and car rental booking** through global partners
- **Travel extras** such as Wi-Fi, special meals, and extra baggage
- **Umrah and Hajj travel packages** tailored for religious travelers
- **Flight status and online check-in** for convenience

HTA Analysis for Saudia



2.3 Emirates

1. **Home Page:** The Emirates homepage features a premium, visually polished interface with a large booking widget centered on the page. Users can select trip type, destinations, dates, cabin class, and passenger count. The homepage also highlights special offers, travel inspiration, and Emirates Skywards loyalty benefits.

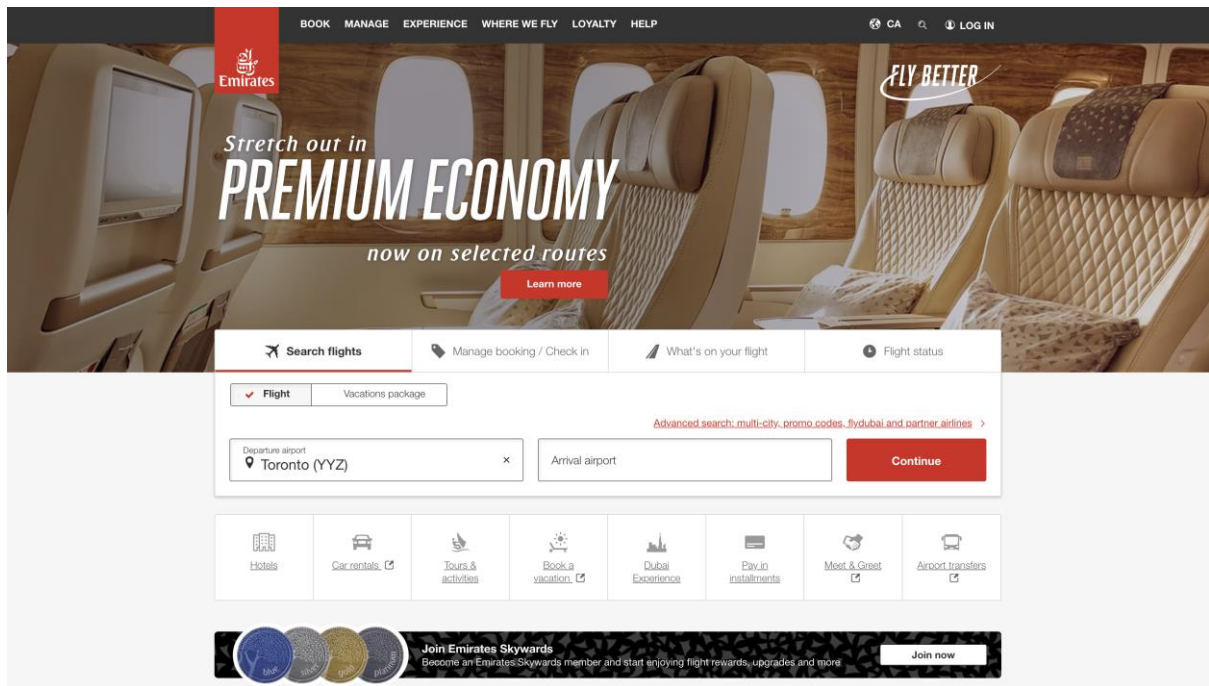


Figure 18. Emirates Homepage

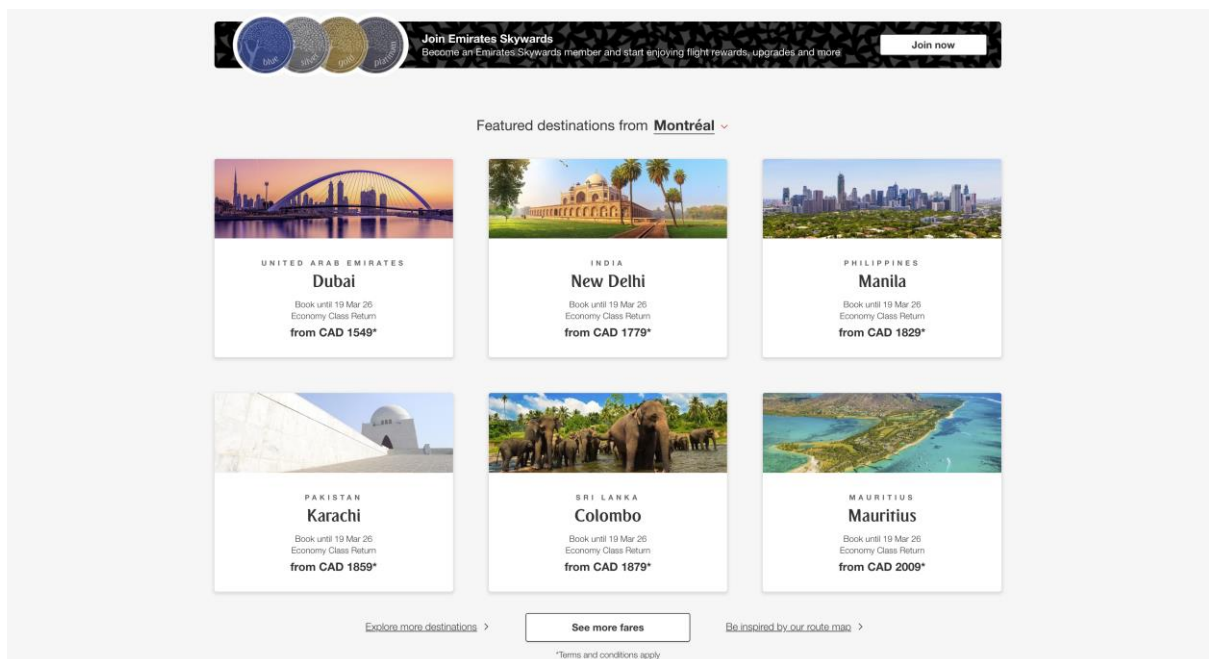


Figure 19. Emirates Homepage continued

2. Flight Booking Process:

The flight booking form is clean and minimalistic, offering:

- Round-trip, one-way, and multi-city options
- Cabin classes (Economy, Premium Economy, Business, First)
- Flexible date search
- Promo code entry
- “Book with Miles” toggle for Skywards members

The interface emphasizes clarity and reduces cognitive load.

Figure 20. Flight Booking Page

3. Flight Results Page

Emirates displays:

- Departure and arrival times
- Aircraft type (A380, Boeing 777, etc.)
- Total travel time and layovers
- Fare categories with detailed inclusions
- Filters for price, schedule, stops, and cabin class

Each flight card includes a “What’s included” section showing meals, baggage, Wi-Fi, and seat features.

Toronto (YYZ) → Dubai (DXB)
Return • 1 passenger [Change search](#)

View summary

Choose your outbound flight

Toronto to Dubai
[View baggage allowances and fees](#)

Lowest total price for 1 passenger **CAD 2,037.14**
or from [CAD 119.62 per month](#)
Inclusive of airfare, taxes, fees and charges
[Change currency](#)

Thursday, 2 April 2026 (1 option)
< Previous day
Next day >

Show prices for: **Economy** Business First
Sort: **Lowest price**

Thu 02 Apr
14:55
YYZ
Toronto

12 hrs 45 mins
Non-stop

Fri 03 Apr
11:40
DXB
Dubai

Economy Class
from **CAD 898.18**
Lowest price

A380 EK242

Economy from CAD 898.18	Premium Economy Not offered	Business from CAD 3,866.75	First from CAD 10,051.75
-----------------------------------	--------------------------------	-------------------------------	-----------------------------

Fare benefits (per person) Compare all services Regular seat selection Cabin baggage	Saver CAD 898.18 Lowest price At a charge 1 x 7 kg	Flex CAD 1,119.18 Complimentary 1 x 7 kg	Flex Plus CAD 2,191.18 Complimentary 1 x 7 kg
---	--	---	--

Figure 21. Search Results Interface

4. Fare Options:

Emirates offers transparent fare families:

- **Economy Saver / Flex / Flex Plus**
- **Premium Economy**
- **Business Saver / Flex / Flex Plus**
- **First Class**

Each fare clearly lists:

- Baggage allowance
- Refundability
- Seat selection rules
- Lounge access (for premium cabins)
- Upgrade eligibility

	Economy from CAD 898.18	Premium Economy Not offered	Business from CAD 3,866.75	First from CAD 10,051.75
Fare benefits (per person) Compare all services				
	Special CAD 3,866.75	Saver CAD 4,449.75	Flex CAD 5,617.75	Flex Plus CAD 7,367.75
Chauffeur-drive	Not eligible	Complimentary	Complimentary	Complimentary
Lounge	Not eligible	Complimentary	Complimentary	Complimentary
Seat selection	Restricted	Complimentary	Complimentary	Complimentary
Cabin baggage	2 x 7 kg	2 x 7 kg	2 x 7 kg	2 x 7 kg
Baggage	2 x 32 kg	2 x 32 kg	2 x 32 kg	2 x 32 kg
Change fee	USD 400.00	USD 300.00	USD 250.00	Complimentary
Refund fee	From USD 600.00	From USD 450.00	USD 375.00	Complimentary
No-show penalty	From USD 800.00	From USD 600.00	From USD 500.00	From USD 500.00
Skywards Miles	6,600 Miles	7,500 Miles	10,500 Miles	11,400 Miles
Upgrade to First	Not permitted	After check-in opens 91,260 Miles	Eligible 80,730 Miles	Eligible 70,200 Miles
	Select	Select	Select	Select

Figure 22. Different Fare Options to choose from based on the class

5. Seat Selection:

Emirates provides a clear explanation of its seat-selection rules before showing any seat map. The airline outlines which seats are complimentary and which require an additional fee. Regular seats are free for Flex fares, while preferred, twin, and extra-legroom seats come at a charge. Emirates also offers early-booking discounts for extra-legroom seats.

The policy emphasizes accessibility and family travel: children under 13 and passengers with disabilities are always seated next to their accompanying adult or companion at no extra cost, regardless of fare type.

This approach prioritizes transparency by helping users understand seat-selection costs and rules before they proceed with choosing a seat.

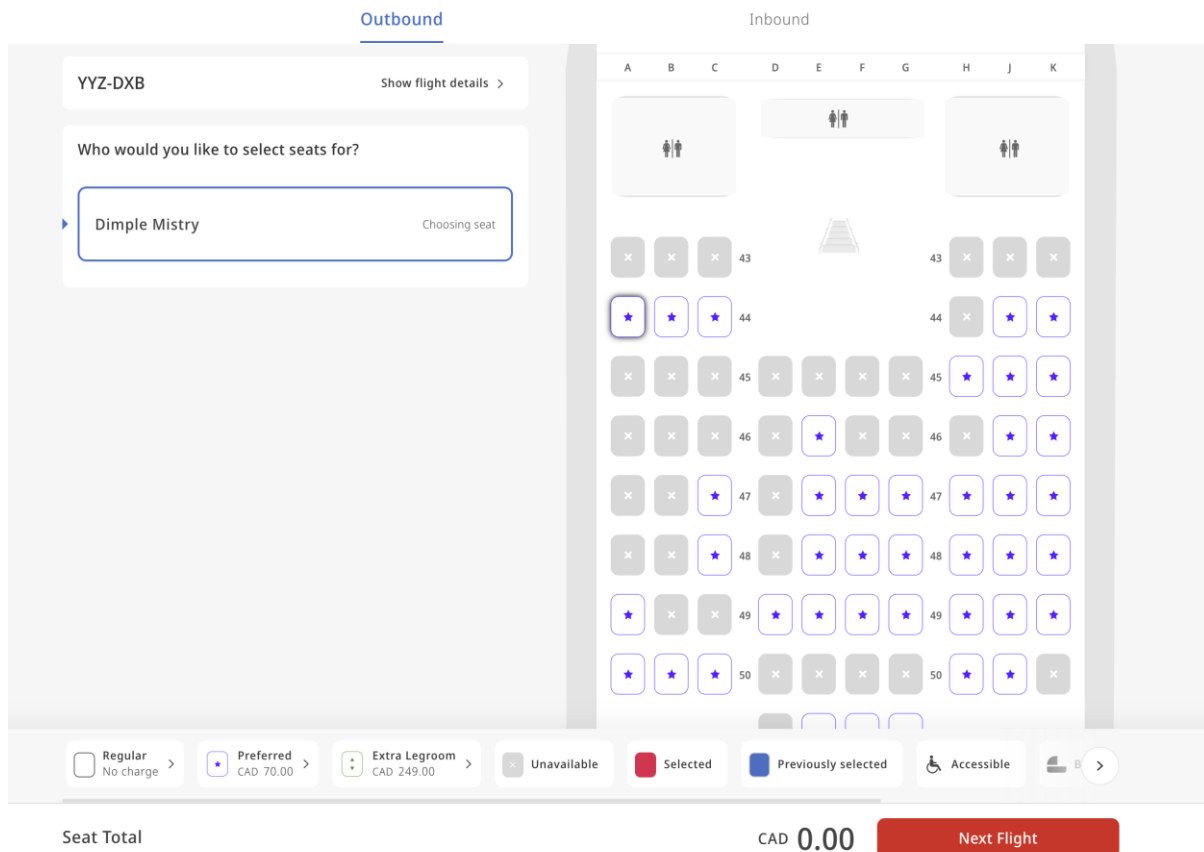


Figure 23. Seat Selection Page

6. Customer Support:

Emirates offers:

- 24/7 global support via phone, chat, and email
- Refund and travel voucher tools
- Baggage claim and tracking
- Travel requirements by country
- Disruption alerts and rebooking tools

The help center is organized into clear categories for easy navigation.

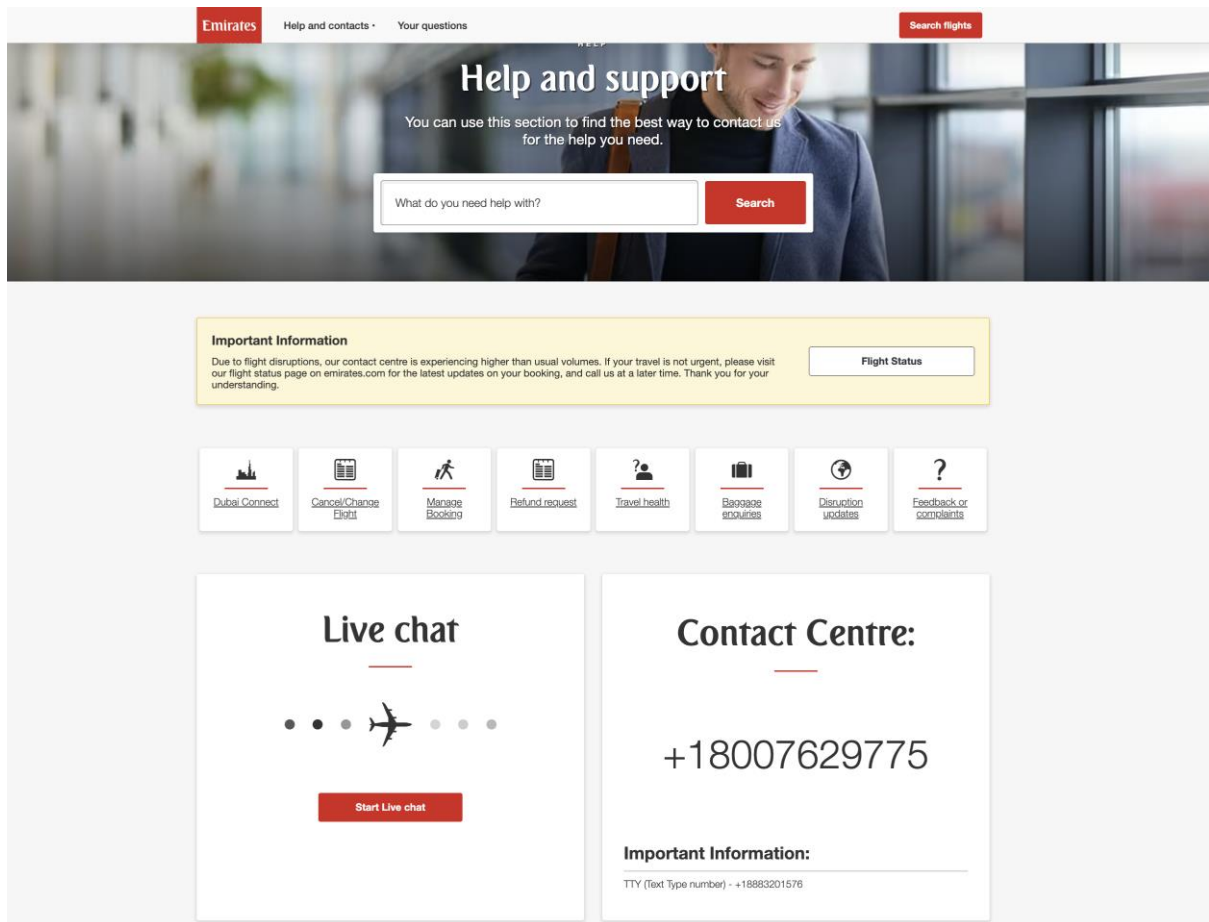


Figure 24. Help And Support Page

7. Additional Services:

Skywards Loyalty Program provides:

- Miles earning on flights, hotels, car rentals, and partners
- Redemption for flights, upgrades, and experiences
- Tier benefits (Blue, Silver, Gold, Platinum)
- Family pooling options

Hotels & Cars:

Emirates partners with global providers to offer:

- Hotel booking
- Car rentals
- Vacation packages
- Bonus miles for partner bookings

8. Travel Extras:

Emirates offers:

- Chauffeur-drive service (Business & First)
- Onboard Wi-Fi
- Special meals
- Extra baggage
- Travel insurance
- Dubai stopover packages

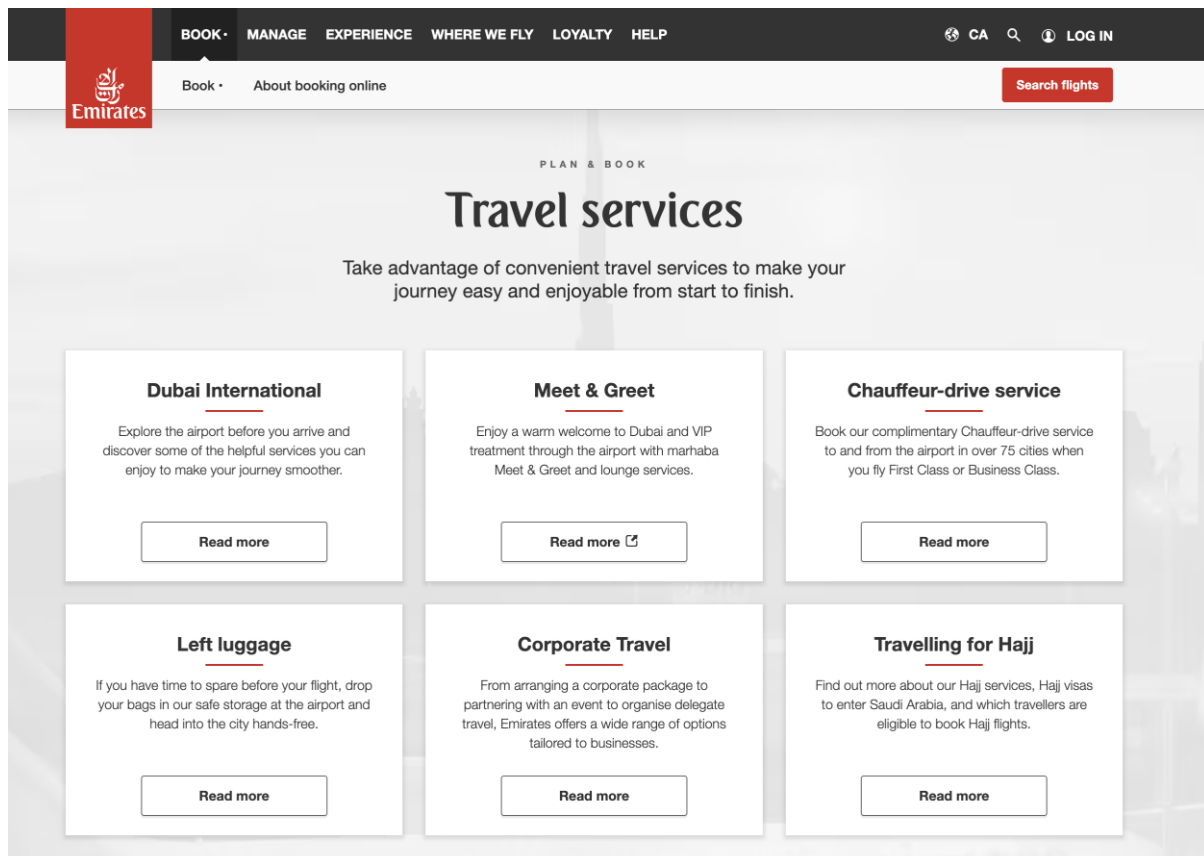


Figure 25. Travel Services Page

9. Accessibility Services:

Emirates includes:

- Wheelchair assistance
- Special seating
- Medical equipment policies
- Travel for passengers with disabilities
- Service animal guidelines

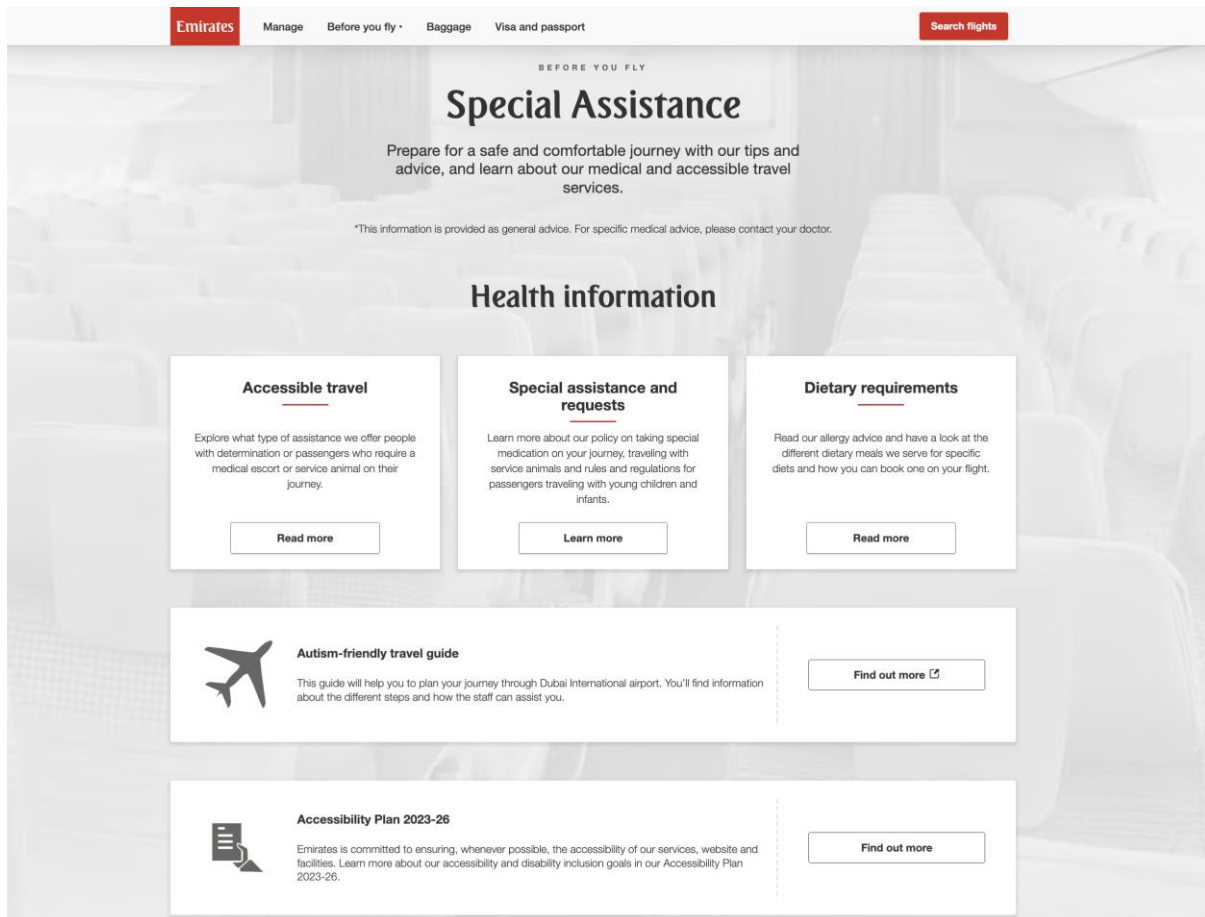


Figure 26. Accessibility Page

Overview

Emirates' website delivers a premium, polished user experience that reflects the airline's global brand. The platform integrates flight search, fare comparison, seat selection, and booking management seamlessly. Additional services such as Skywards loyalty rewards, chauffeur-drive, hotel bookings, and Dubai stopover packages enhance the overall user experience.

The navigation menu is consistent across all pages, making it easy for users to switch between booking, managing trips, checking in, and exploring loyalty benefits.

Key Features

Flight Booking

- Intuitive search interface
- Detailed flight results with filters
- Transparent fare breakdowns
- Multi-cabin seat previews

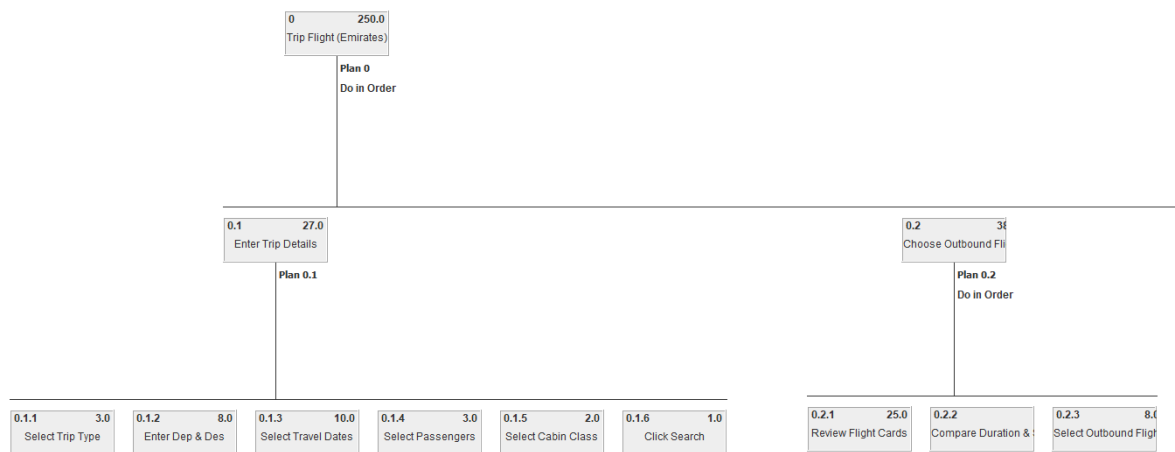
Customer Support

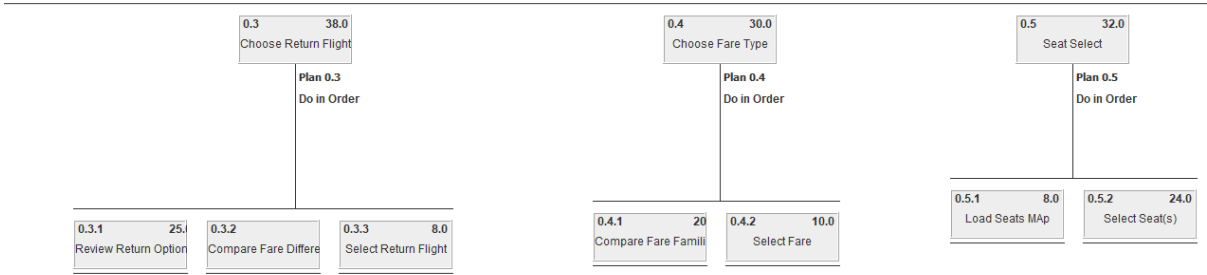
- Travel advisories
- Baggage information
- Refund and rebooking tools
- 24/7 global support

Additional Services

- Skywards loyalty program
- Hotels and car rentals
- Chauffeur-drive service
- Dubai stopover packages
- Flight status and check-in

HTA Analysis for Emirates





2.4 Airline Site Interface Comparison

Evaluation Factor	Air Canada	Saudia Airlines	Emirates
Homepage Design	Functional and task-focused with booking tool prominently placed.	Visually rich and brand-driven layout.	Premium and polished layout with balanced focus.
Ease of Starting Booking	Quick access to booking but slightly dense.	Clear booking widget but visual distractions present.	Clean and minimal – easiest to start booking.
Search Interface Clarity	Clear fields but includes additional options that may confuse users.	Logically grouped inputs but advanced options may overwhelm beginners.	Simple and minimal interface with flexible date options.
Flight Results Layout	Detailed but information heavy	Structured card layout with expandable details.	Clear layout with “What’s Included” transparency.
Fare Comparison Transparency	Highly detailed but complex.	Clear fare differences.	Most intuitive fare structure.
Seat Selection Process	Visual seat maps improve understanding.	Limited explanation before selection.	Explains seat rules before selection (reduces surprises).

Information Overload Risk	Medium – many fare tiers shown.	Medium–High – data-heavy pages.	Low – progressive disclosure of info.
Pricing Transparency	Good breakdown shown at review stage.	Clear fare benefits shown early.	Best clarity on inclusions (Wi-Fi, meals, baggage).
Error Prevention	Session timeout recovery available.	AI assistant supports decision-making.	Clear explanations before choices reduce mistakes.
Customer Support	Strong support tools available.	AI assistant + multilingual support.	Well-organized global help center.
Accessibility Support	Most comprehensive accessibility breakdown.	Clearly structured accessibility info.	Focus on practical assistance for travelers.
Navigation Consistency	Consistent across pages.	Consistent and intuitive.	Highly consistent and structured.
Cognitive Load	Moderate	Moderate–High	Low
Emotional Reassurance	Functional but less comforting.	Friendly and engaging.	Premium and confidence-building.
Suitability for Stress-Free Booking	Good transparency but complex options.	Supportive but visually busy.	Most calming and user-friendly experience.

2.5 Site Critique

Air Canada:

Air Canada's website has a clean and professional interface, especially on the homepage search section. The layout is structured and easy to understand at the beginning of the booking process. However, once users reach the results page, the interface becomes visually dense. Multiple fare options are displayed at the same time, which can feel overwhelming and increase decision fatigue. The frequent presentation of add-ons (such as baggage and upgrades) interrupts the flow and may make the experience feel sales-driven rather than user-focused. While the system is functional and complete, simplifying the results layout and reducing interruptions could improve the overall user experience.

Saudia:

Saudia's booking interface follows a clear step-by-step structure, which helps users understand where they are in the process. The design is straightforward and less visually overwhelming compared to some competitors. However, certain sections rely heavily on form inputs, which increases typing effort and may slow down the process. The visual hierarchy could be improved, as some important information does not stand out clearly from secondary details. While the overall flow is logical and organized, better spacing, clearer typography, and stronger visual emphasis could enhance usability.

Emirates:

Emirates provides a visually polished and well-organized booking experience. The interface uses clear spacing, structured sections, and a visible progress indicator to guide users through each stage. Information is grouped logically, which helps reduce confusion and supports smoother navigation. Compared to the other systems analyzed, Emirates appears to manage visual hierarchy more effectively, making the process feel less overwhelming. Although optional services are still presented, they are integrated in a way that feels less disruptive to the booking flow. Overall, Emirates demonstrates a stronger balance between functionality and clarity.

Section 3: Personas

Based on our analysis of Air Canada, Saudia, and Emirates, along with our survey findings, we identified two key user types that represent common airline booking behaviors. These personas reflect recurring patterns in user goals, frustrations, and interaction styles observed across the three systems.

Primary Persona – Budget Conscious Independent Traveller

This persona represents younger or frequent independent travelers who prioritize price transparency, efficiency, and simplicity. Our critiques showed that systems like Air Canada introduce cognitive overload through multiple fare tiers and upselling, while Emirates performs better by structuring decisions more clearly. From both the interface analysis and survey responses, it became evident that users in this category are most affected by visual clutter, hidden fees, and decision fatigue.

We selected this persona as primary because:

- They are highly sensitive to complexity and price confusion.
- They are more likely to abandon bookings if overwhelmed.
- They represent a large portion of digital-first airline users.
- Designing for simplicity benefits all other users.

Their core need is to book quickly, understand total costs clearly, and avoid unnecessary interruptions.

Secondary Persona – Organized Family Planner

This persona represents users booking for multiple passengers, often prioritizing coordination, seat selection, and policy clarity over the lowest possible price. Our evaluation of Saudia and Air Canada showed that form-heavy sections and unclear policy access can increase friction for these users. While Emirates manages structured progression effectively, booking for families still introduces complexity.

We identified this persona as secondary because:

- Their needs introduce additional system requirements (multi-passenger input, seating coordination).
- However, designing primarily around this complexity could increase interface clutter for independent travelers.
- Their needs can be supported through progressive disclosure rather than dominating the core design.

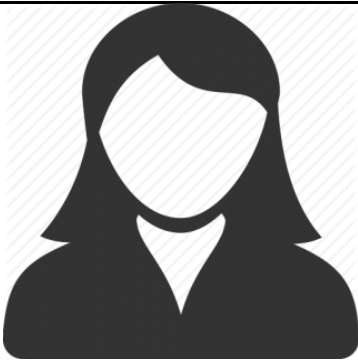
Their core need is clarity, organization, and confidence when managing multiple travelers.

Overall Persona Selection Strategy

By selecting the Budget-Conscious Independent Traveler as the primary persona, our proposed system will prioritize clarity, reduce cognitive load, and streamline decision-making. The Family Planner persona ensures that the design still supports more complex bookings without overwhelming primary users.

This balanced approach allows the system to remain focused, efficient, and scalable across different user types.

Persona Template 1:

	Name: Aisha Patel Personal Info: • Age: 22 • Occupation: Student • Income: Limited (budget-conscious) • Travels: 2–3 times per year • Books independently
Technology: • Heavy smartphone user • Uses Chrome/Safari • Comfortable with online payments • Expects fast-loading, responsive interfaces	Habits, Behavior, Interests: • Uses laptop or mobile to compare flights • Opens multiple tabs to compare pricing • Double-checks final price before payment • Looks for student discounts or promo codes • Often feels overwhelmed by add-ons
Bio (past and present): Aisha is a 22-year-old business student who flies 2–3 times a year to visit family and friends. She books her own flights and usually looks for the lowest price. While she is familiar with airline websites, she is not an expert traveler. She often books	Skills: • Comfortable using web applications • Understands basic fare categories • Able to navigate booking systems independently

under time pressure, especially during exam breaks or holiday sales.	
Personal Goals: • Save money whenever possible • Travel home without financial stress • Feel confident she selected the best deal • Avoid unexpected fees	Frustrations: • Hidden baggage fees • Aggressive upselling • Too many fare options • Confusing refund policies • Fear of making a mistake in passenger information
Immediate Goals: • Quickly compare prices across dates • Book the cheapest flight with acceptable travel time • Understand baggage rules before checkout • Complete payment without confusion	Social: • Travels to visit family and friends • Sometimes books flights with friends • Relies on peer recommendations for trusted websites

Persona Template 2

	Name: Miachel Thompson Personal Info: • Age: 39 • Occupation: Marketing Manager • Travels: 1–2 times per year • Books for family of four • Medium to high income
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Technology: • Desktop-first user • Uses saved payment methods • Expects secure and professional interfaces • Appreciates confirmation emails and booking summaries	Habits, Behavior, Interests: • Researches flights carefully before booking • Reviews policies before checkout • Values customer support accessibility • Prefers desktop booking for detailed review
Bio (past and present): Michael is a 39-year-old marketing manager and father of two. He books flights 1–2 times per year for family vacations. He values organization and prefers planning trips in advance. Unlike Aisha, he prioritizes comfort, baggage clarity, and flexible cancellation policies over absolute lowest price.	Skills: • Comfortable using web applications • Understands basic fare categories • Able to navigate booking systems independently
Personal Goals: • Plan smooth, stress-free family travel • Ensure seat selection together • Avoid surprises during travel • Minimize logistical errors	Frustrations: • Re-entering passenger details • Unclear baggage pricing • Complex seat maps • Poor visibility of customer support • Time-consuming booking steps
Immediate Goals: • Book round-trip flights for 4 passengers • Select seats together • Confirm baggage allowance clearly • Understand cancellation/refund policies	Social: • Books travel for entire family • Coordinates travel schedules with spouse • Values reliability and trust in airline brand

Section 4: User Goals

Based on our analysis of Air Canada, Saudia, and Emirates, along with our survey findings, we selected the Budget-Conscious Independent Traveler as our primary persona and the Organized Family Planner as our secondary persona. Our website critiques showed that information density, multiple fare tiers, and frequent add-ons can increase cognitive load and decision fatigue, especially for users who are price-sensitive and booking independently. Because this group is more likely to abandon the booking process when overwhelmed, designing primarily for them ensures simplicity, clarity, and reduced complexity across the interface. The Family Planner was selected as a secondary persona because their needs—such as multi-passenger coordination, seat selection, and policy clarity—introduce additional system requirements but should not dominate the core design. By prioritizing the independent traveler while still supporting the family planner through structured and accessible features, the interface remains streamlined while accommodating more complex booking scenarios.

Key Points

Primary Persona:

- Start booking immediately without distractions
- Compare flights easily based on price, duration, and stops
- See total cost transparency early in the process
- Move through a clear, step-by-step booking flow
- Avoid confusion caused by multiple fare tiers
- Minimize interruptions from add-ons and upselling
- Prevent errors during passenger and payment entry
- Feel confident before confirming payment

Secondary Persona:

- Manage multiple passengers efficiently
- Select seats together with clear visibility of seat policies
- Understand baggage and cancellation rules before checkout
- Access customer support and travel policies easily
- Review full booking summary before payment

Shared Goals:

- Reduce stress during booking
- Avoid information overload
- Feel in control of decisions
- Trust the system with personal and financial information

- Complete booking quickly and confidently

Section 5: Interface Presentation

The proposed interface design focuses on clarity, transparency, and reduced cognitive load throughout the airline booking process. Based on our evaluation of Air Canada, Saudia, and Emirates, we identified key usability issues such as information overload, excessive fare tiers, form-heavy interactions, and disruptive upselling. Our redesigned interface aims to address these issues while supporting both primary and secondary personas.

The homepage prioritizes the core task of flight search by placing a clean, centralized booking module at the center of the screen with minimal distractions. Promotional content is reduced to prevent visual clutter and allow users to begin their task immediately. The layout follows a strong visual hierarchy, using spacing and typography to emphasize essential elements such as destination, date, and passenger count.

The flight results page simplifies comparison by highlighting only the most important variables: price, duration, and number of stops. Instead of displaying all fare tiers at once, additional details are revealed through progressive disclosure, allowing users to access more information only when needed. A persistent price summary panel is displayed throughout the booking process to maintain transparency and reduce uncertainty.

The booking flow is structured into clearly defined steps, supported by a visible progress indicator at the top of the screen. This approach reduces anxiety and helps users understand where they are in the process. Forms are designed with grouped fields, inline validation, and clear error messaging to prevent mistakes during passenger information entry.

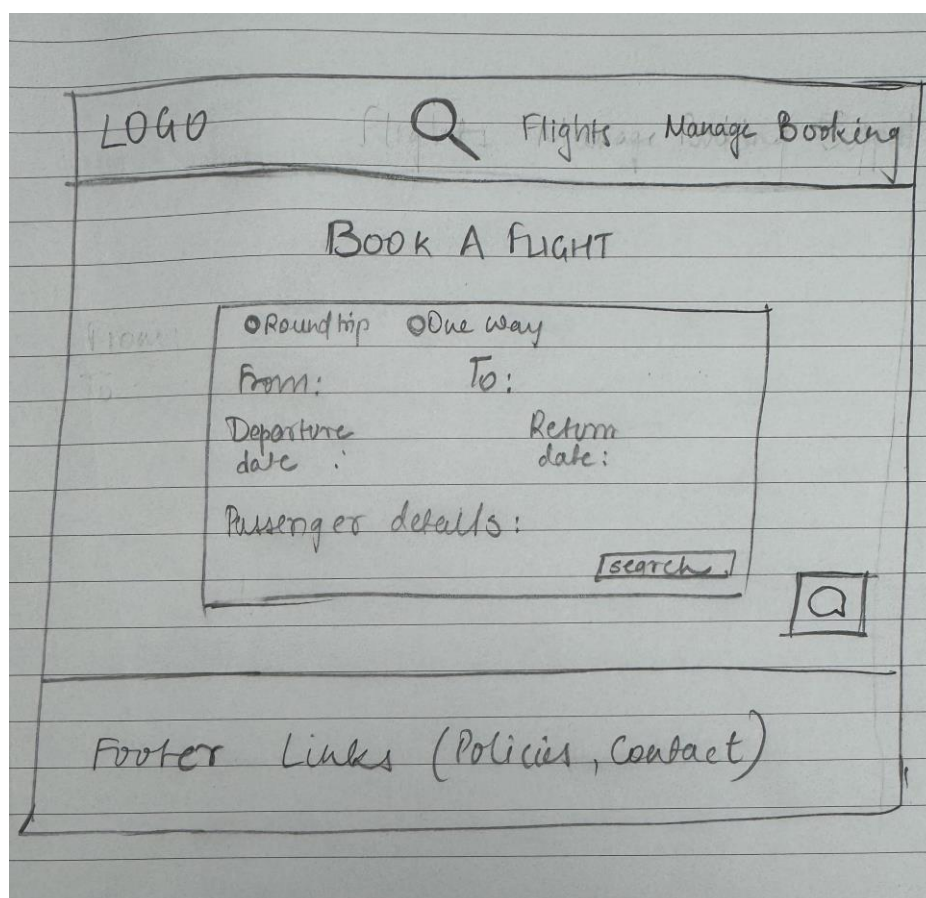
Optional services such as seat selection and baggage are integrated into the flow without interrupting the primary task. Policy information is accessible through expandable sections, allowing users to review important details without leaving the booking page.

Overall, the interface prioritizes simplicity, guided navigation, and cost transparency to create a smoother and more confident booking experience.

Section 6: Storyboard

The storyboard reflects a task-focused, structured booking experience designed to reduce cognitive overload and improve transparency. The conceptual model treats the booking process as a guided journey with clearly defined stages, allowing users to move forward confidently without being overwhelmed. By simplifying comparison, maintaining price visibility, and emphasizing clarity over promotion, the proposed design supports both independent travelers and more complex booking scenarios while maintaining a streamlined interface.

Homepage



Metaphor:

The homepage functions as a “departure board entry point.” Just like an airport departure screen focuses only on essential travel information, this page prioritizes the booking task above all else.

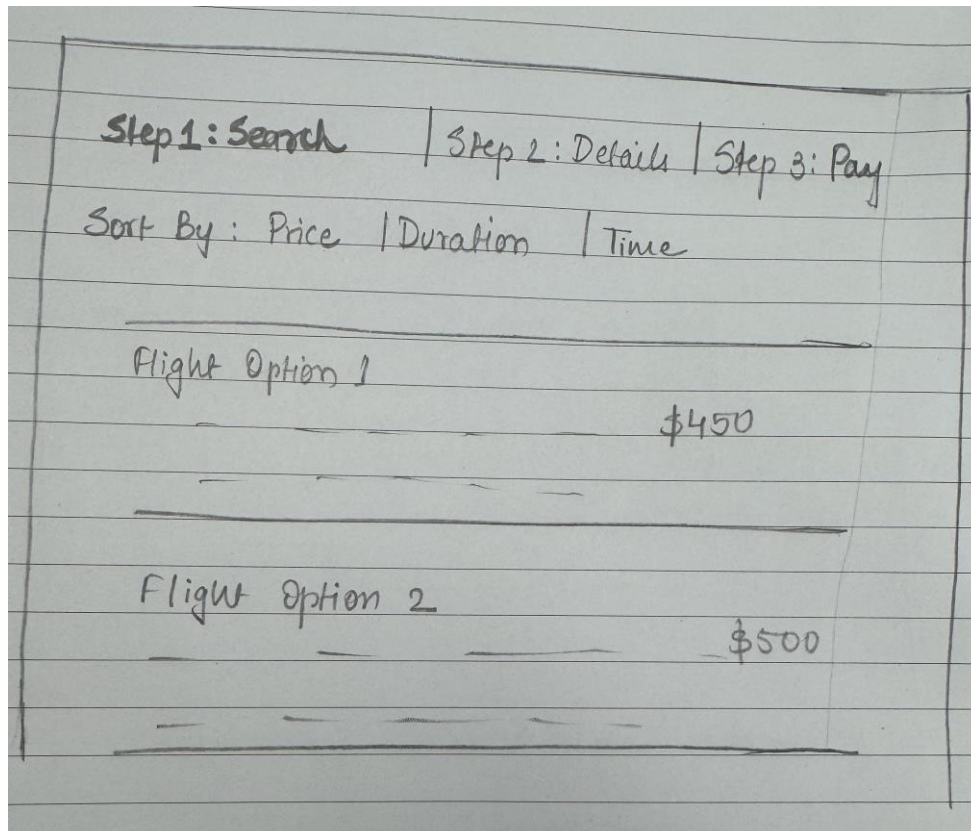
Conceptual Design Ideas:

- **Task-first design:** The interface immediately supports the primary goal: searching for flights.

- **Reduced cognitive load:** Minimal promotions and visual distractions.
- **Strong visual hierarchy:** Central booking module draws immediate attention.
- **Clarity over persuasion:** Unlike Air Canada's heavier promotional presence, this layout removes pressure-based marketing.

This supports the primary persona's need for efficiency and simplicity.

Flight Results Page



Metaphor:

This page acts like a “comparison shelf” in a store. Users compare a small number of clearly presented options before choosing, instead of being overwhelmed by excessive fare tiers.

Conceptual Design Ideas:

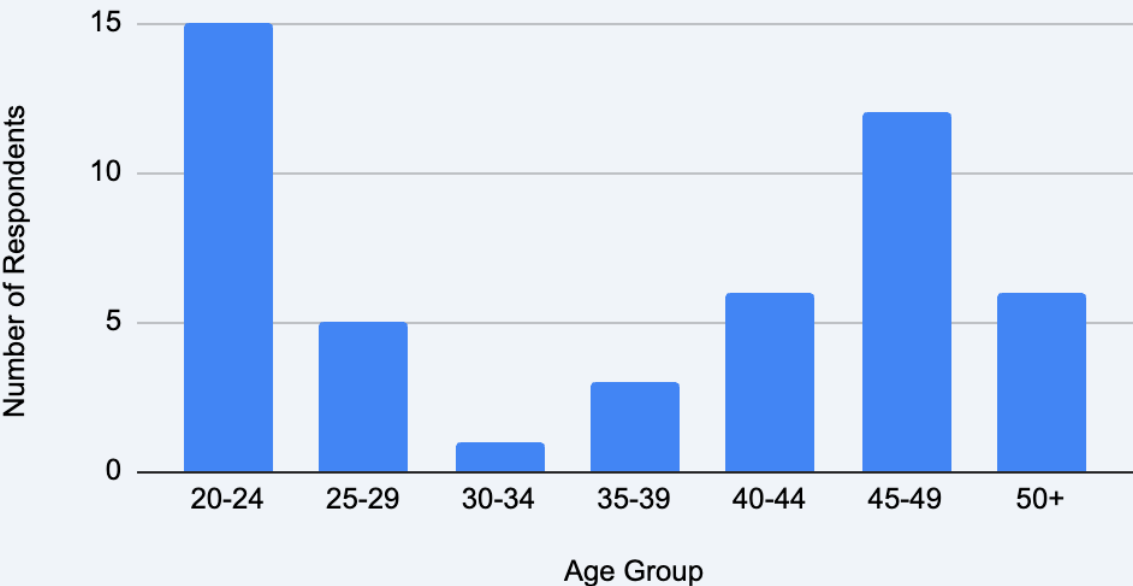
- **Progressive disclosure:** “View Details” reveals more information only when needed.
- **Transparency:** Persistent price summary panel reduces uncertainty.
- **Visibility of system status:** Progress bar shows where the user is in the booking flow.
- **Reduced decision fatigue:** Only essential comparison variables are emphasized (price, duration, stops).

This directly improves upon:

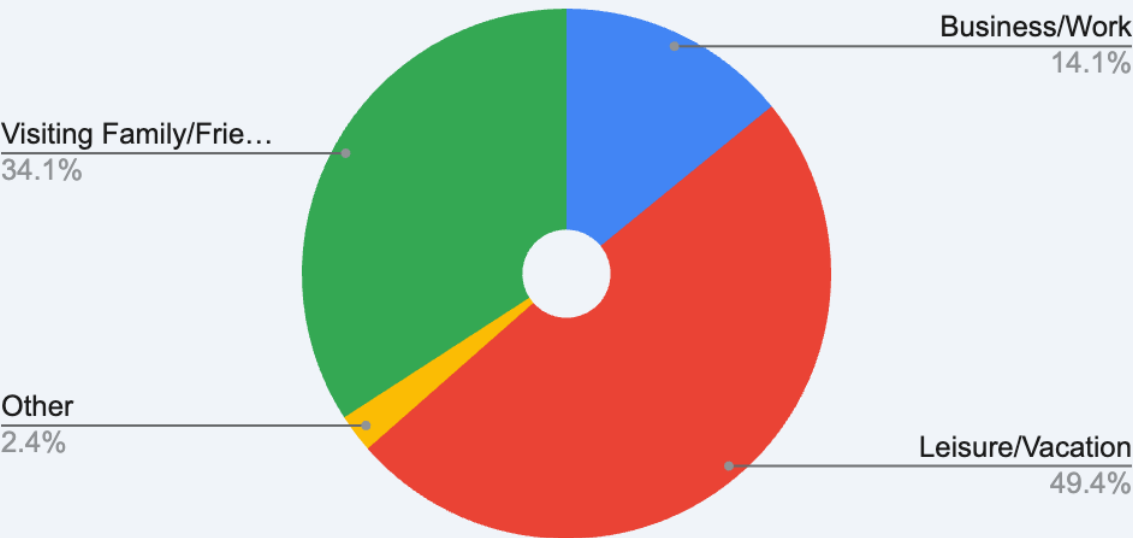
- Air Canada's dense fare grid
- Saudia's form-heavy interaction
- Builds on Emirates' structured progression model

Appendix D: Survey Results

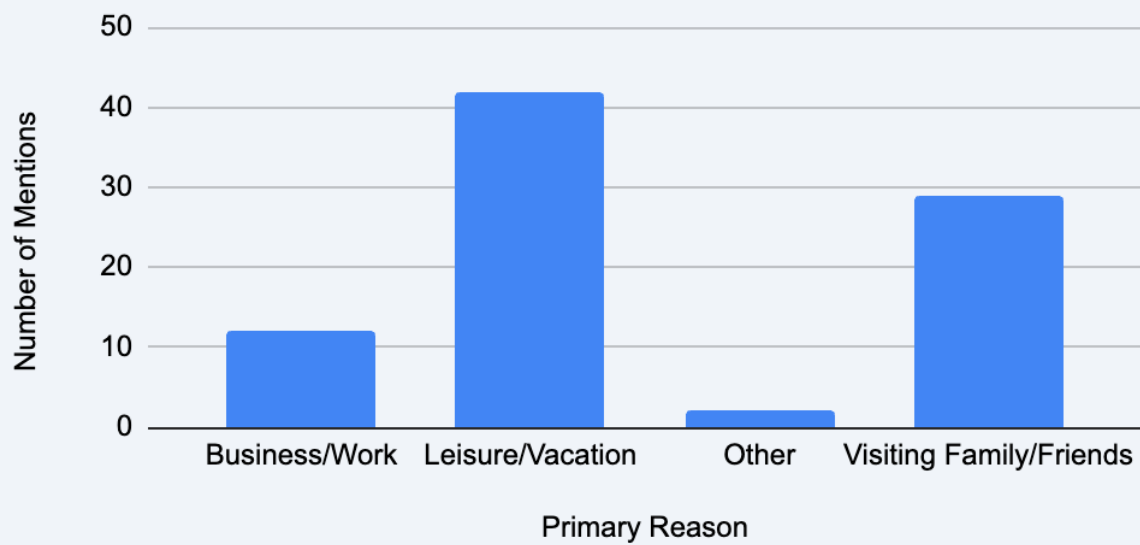
Distribution of Respondent Age



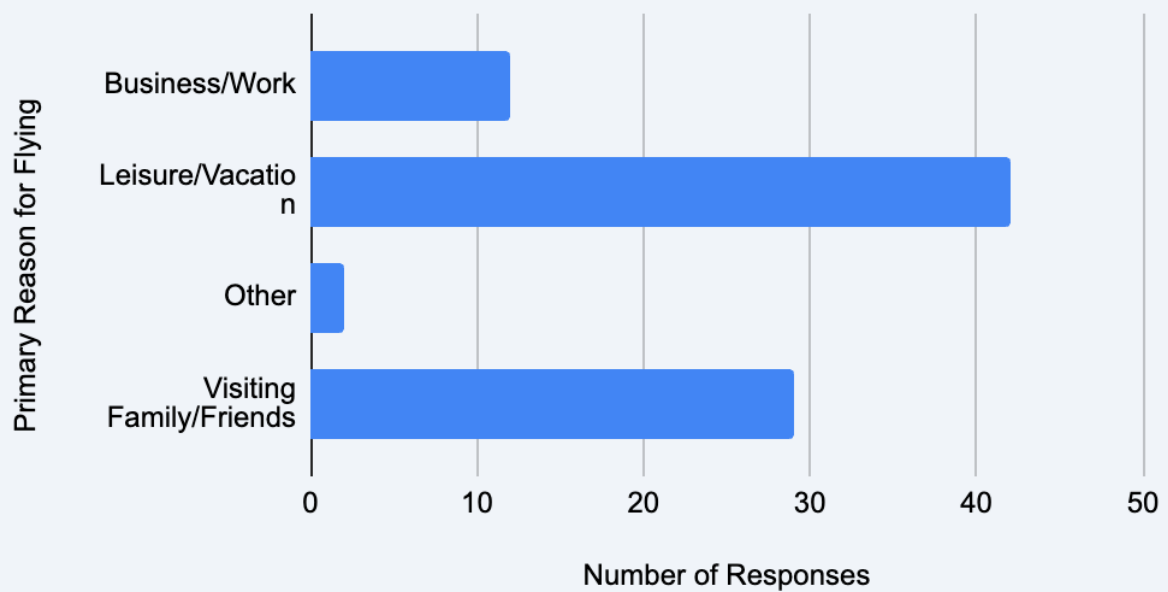
Percentage Breakdown of Primary Reasons for Flying



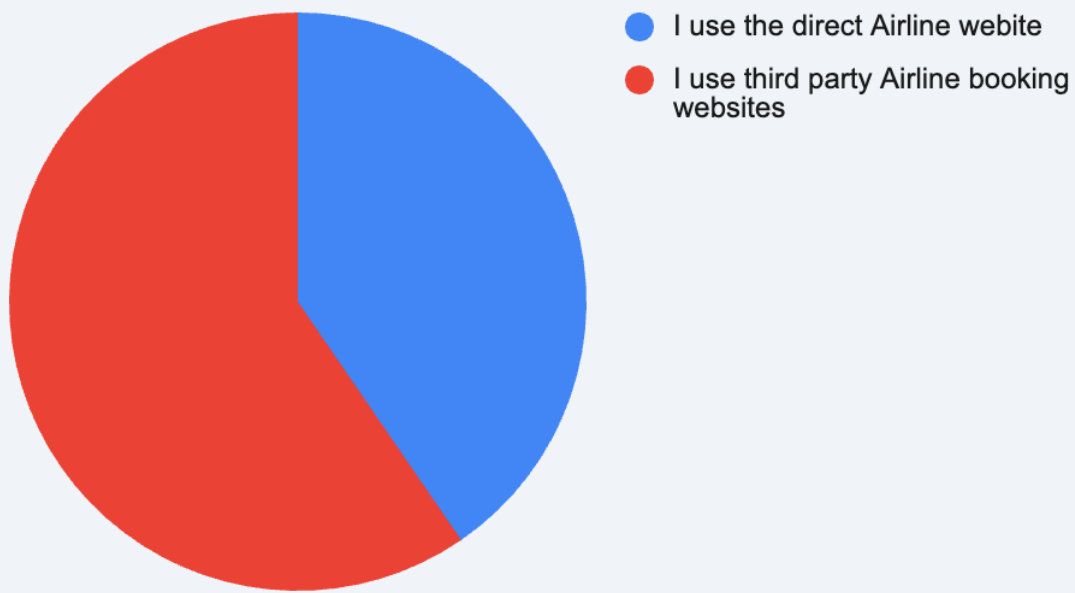
Primary Reasons for Flying (Multiple Selections Possible)



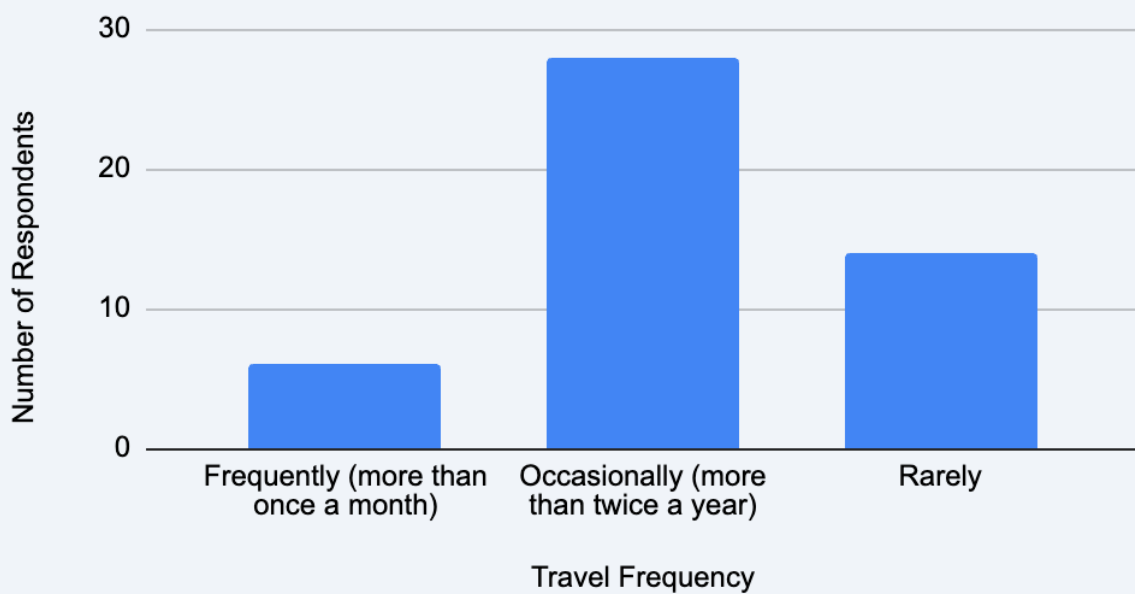
Primary Reason for Flying



Airline vs. Third-Party Booking Website Usage



Distribution of Air Travel Frequency



Appendix E: Links

The Site specific HTA files are linked with the submission zip file

Website Analysis:

- Air Canada
<https://www.aircanada.com/home/us/en/aco/flights>
- Saudia
<https://www.saudia.com>
- Emirates
<https://www.emirates.com>

Survey Data Raw File:

https://brocku.sharepoint.com/:x:/r/sites/Group6_9v1ow7/_layouts/15/Doc2.aspx?action=edit&sourcedoc=%7B2e27a6b9-32e8-4ad6-8911-5abeb5b28e95%7D&wdOrigin=TEAMS-WEB.teamsSdk_ns.rwc&wdExp=TEAMS-TREATMENT&wdhostclicktime=1772511237125&web=1